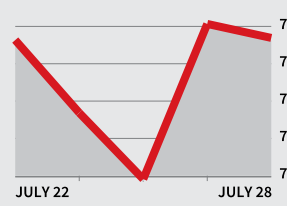


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 76765.92 (-69.86)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23985.35	-10.60
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.62	-0.02
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.85	-0.06
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	141721.00	-2167
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	217349.00	-7098

DIVERSIFIED FEEDSTOCK.

Lower maize acreage and tight supplies of sugarcane may force ethanol makers to explore rice as an option **p10**



UNDER THE LENS.

SC says it will consider constituting a high-power team to probe police excesses during CJP protests **p11**

QUICKLY.

ROBUST MANUFACTURING

Industrial output hits 23-month high in June

New Delhi: Driven by a strong performance in manufacturing and electricity, alongside a favourable base effect, industrial output surged to a 23-month high of 7.3 per cent in June, up from a revised 5 per cent in May, government data showed on Tuesday. “In June, the Index of Industrial Production recorded a 7.3 per cent growth, supported by 7.8 per cent growth in the manufacturing sector and strong growth of 10.6 per cent in the electricity and gas supply sector,” the National Statistics Office said in a release. **p3**

CANCER CLAIMS

J&J agrees to pay \$5.5 b to settle talc-related cases

Johnson & Johnson on Monday said it agreed to a \$5.5 billion commitment to resolve years of litigation related to claims that its talc products caused ovarian cancer. The drugmaker said the proposed resolution represents “an efficient conclusion” to the lawsuits. The agreement requires the participation of lead plaintiff firms in ovarian talc litigation pending in state and federal courts that represent at least 95 per cent of claims, according to J&J. If enough plaintiffs sign on, the settlement will help bring to a close an issue that has dogged J&J for at least 15 years. **p12**

In FCNR (B) race, small banks raise deposit rates to woo NRIs

GAMBIT. These banks are offering interest rates 150 bps higher than large lenders

K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

Small and mid-size banks, not wanting to be left behind in the race to mobilise fresh foreign currency non-resident (bank), or FCNR (B), deposits, are playing the “interest rate” gambit.

These banks are overcoming the inability to offer leverage to their non-resident Indian (NRI) customers by upping interest rates on these deposits so that their customers don’t shift elsewhere.

RATE HIKE

For example, Equitas Small Finance Bank (SFB) has upped its interest rate on FCNR (B) deposits of \$10,000 and above and in the 3-5 years tenor from 7.13 per cent to 7.52 per cent.

Likewise, AU Small Finance Bank raised its FCNR (B) deposit rates from 7.1 per cent to 7.4 per cent for the 3 to less than 4-year tenure, irrespective of the size of the deposit.

Tamilnad Mercantile Bank had increased interest rates on FCNR(B) deposits of 3-5 years tenure from 7 per cent to 7.25 per cent, irrespective

THE RATE CARD

- Equitas SFB has upped its interest rate on FCNR (B) deposits of \$10,000 and above and in the 3-5 years tenor from 7.13% to 7.52%
- AU SFB has raised its deposit rate from 7.1% to 7.4%
- TMB increased interest rate from 7% to 7.25%



of the size of the deposit, earlier this month.

The interest rates being quoted by these banks are, on average, about 150 basis points higher than those offered by large banks such as State Bank of India, HDFC Bank and ICICI Bank.

Equitas Small Finance Bank MD and CEO PN Vasudevan said: “It is not that NRIs will only go for leverage and there will be no deposit outside of leverage. Some large banks have a minimum deposit size of, say, half a million to a million dollars, for offering leverage.”

“While some NRIs will have the wherewithal to place this quantum of deposit and take leverage against it, not everybody will

have these kinds of resources at their disposal. Given the size (total deposits: ₹48,976 crore and gross advances: ₹47,641 crore) of our bank, we don’t need \$2 billion.”

Vasudevan emphasised that even if the FCNR (B) deposit size can be doubled or taken beyond that, it will be a great benefit for his bank in terms of supporting credit growth. The bank’s FCNR deposit, which was launched in Q3 (October-December) FY26, has already garnered about \$42 million.

KEY CHANNEL

According to AU SFB, FCNR deposits remain a key channel for mobilising overseas Indian savings into India, while offering protection

against exchange rate fluctuations.

The bank, in a statement, said the revision in its deposit rates is further supported by the RBI’s announcement regarding “Swap Facility for FCNR(B) deposits”, which provides additional headroom for banks to offer more competitive foreign currency deposit rates.

Constrained in offering leverage to NRI customers as they neither have overseas branches nor a presence in the GIFT (Gujarat International Finance Tec) City, small and mid-sized banks are also trying to negotiate with foreign banks so that their NRI customers can get loans (leverage).

The loan proceeds can be placed as FCNR (B) deposits with the former. The loans will be offered by the foreign banks to NRIs on the strength of the standby letter of credit issued by the Indian banks.

In an interaction with *businessline* on July 26, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra had observed that beginning June 8 till date, banks had mobilised almost \$32 billion, with most of it coming through FCNR (B) deposits.

Meta apologises to govt on PM’s FB video glitch

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Meta has apologised to the government after a video featuring Prime Minister Narendra Modi was briefly taken down from Facebook in India due to, what it called, a “technical glitch.” “The content was removed in error and has since been restored,” a Meta spokesperson said.

Government sources said the Centre is treating the incident seriously and is examining both Meta’s explanation and the circumstances that led to the video’s take-down. They also said Meta’s explanation was not reasonable, and deeper discussions were needed, adding that the matter is “not settled and done”.

Government officials said that if a glitch in the automated system caused the error, then Meta must improve its tools. Meta’s Global Head of Public Policy has been summoned by MeitY over the issue.

HOUSE PANEL SUMMONS

Independently, the Parliamentary Standing Committee on IT and Communications has summoned representatives of Meta, Snapchat, X and Google on August 3 to discuss other issues.

Details p9

HUL Q1 net dips amid inflation, one-time tax credit in FY26

Scorecard

	June quarter		
	2026	2025	y-o-y %change
Revenue (total income)	17,529	15,958	+10
EBITDA	3,947	3,640	+8
Profit after tax (before exceptional)	2,731	2,498	+9
Reported PAT	2,680	2,741	-2*

* Reported PAT declined due to a one-off tax credit in Q2'25.

Anupama Ghosh
Amrit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Hindustan Unilever Ltd’s June quarter earnings highlighted the trade-off facing India’s largest FMCG company; its strongest underlying sales growth in 13 quarters was shadowed by renewed commodity inflation, margin pressures and fresh questions over how much pricing power it can exercise without hurting demand.

HUL’s reported net profit declined 2 per cent year-on-year to ₹2,680 crore, although the fall largely reflected a one-off tax credit in the year-ago quarter. On a comparable basis, profit after tax before exceptional items rose 9 per cent to ₹2,731 crore.

“The FMCG demand environment remains stable, reflecting the underlying strength of consumption,”

HUL said, adding that “in spite of the Middle East crisis and in spite of the inflationary pressure, we continue to see a robust consumer demand,” said Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director Priya Nair.

Revenues grew 10 per cent year-on-year to ₹17,529 crore. This top-line trajectory was anchored by an underlying sales growth of 10 per cent, the highest growth rate delivered in 13 quarters, and a broad-based underlying volume growth of 5 per cent. “We continue to guide for FY27 doing better than FY26... Our focus remains clear and unchanged — driving competitive volume-led growth,” Nair said.

“Despite the resilient top-line, the post-earnings selloff was triggered by segment-specific volume friction, cost inflation warnings and macro headwinds,” said Mayank Jain, Market Analyst, ShareMarket by PhonePe.

CITY UNION BANK

Deposits
₹ 79,342 Cr
21%

Advances
₹ 67,645 Cr
25%

OP. Profit
₹ 581 Cr
29%

Net Profit
₹ 383 Cr
25%

RoA
1.57%

RoE
14.37%

NIM
3.78%

Gross NPA
1.73%

Net NPA
0.61%

Built on Trust.
Driven by Innovation.

CUB 2.0

Loan Against Property

MSME Loan

Home Loan

Gold Loan

NRI Services

CUB All in one Mobile App

Loan Against Mutual Fund

Locker Facility

Digital Banking

Term Deposit

Salary Account

Current Account

Savings Account

UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026

(₹ in Lakhs)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Quarter ended 30.06.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended 30.06.2025 (Unaudited)	Year ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
1	Total Income from operations (Net)	222857.44	184920.40	790858.57
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	50257.32	38091.96	167123.10
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before Tax (before tax after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	50257.32	38091.96	167123.10
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	38257.32	30591.96	132623.10
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital (face value of ₹1/- each)	9907.87	7410.08	7430.47
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)			1049055.85
8	Securities Premium Account	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
9	Net Worth	1090523.13	968550.52	1045823.78
10	Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt (%)	Nil	Nil	Nil
11	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares	Nil	Nil	Nil
12	Debt Equity Ratio*	0.16	0.09	0.18
13	Earnings per share (before and after extraordinary items) (of ₹1/- each) (not annualised)			
	- Basic	3.86	3.09	13.40
	- Diluted	3.85	3.08	13.38
14	Total debt to total assets(%)**	5.25	2.19	5.49
15	Capital Redemption Reserve			
16	Debenture Redemption Reserve			
17	Debt Service Coverage Ratio			
18	Interest Service Coverage Ratio			

* Debt represents borrowings with residual maturity of more than one year ** Total Debt represents Total borrowings of the Bank

Note: The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Result filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Result is available on the Stock Exchange Websites BSE: <http://www.bseindia.com>, NSE: <http://www.nseindia.com> and Bank website: <http://www.cityunionbank.bank.in>

Place : Chennai
Date : 28th July 2026

QR CODE for Result

By Order of the Board
VIJAY ANANDH R
MD & CEO
DIN: 09656376

CIN No. : L65110TN1904PLC001287 Regd. Office: 149, T.S.R. (Big) Street, Kumbakonam - 612 001. 044-71225000 www.cityunionbank.bank.in Follow us on :

QUICKLY.

Nandita Sinha to take over as Instamart CEO



Bengaluru: Swiggy has appointed former Myntra Chief Executive Officer Nandita Sinha as the Chief Executive Officer of its quick commerce business Instamart effective August 3, as the company looks to strengthen leadership amid intensifying competition in the fast-growing quick commerce segment. Sinha succeeds Amitesh Jha, who led Instamart through a key phase of expansion. Swiggy did not disclose Jha's next role. "Nandita is one of India's most accomplished consumer Internet leaders, and I'm enthusiastic about the vision, customer obsession and operational rigour she brings to the team we've built at Instamart," said Sriharsha Majety, MD and Group CEO of Swiggy. OUR BUREAU

TVS Motor raises stake in TVS Credit to 85.15%



Chennai: TVS Motor Company Ltd has acquired 1,13,37,297 equity shares of TVS Credit Services Ltd (TVSCS), a subsidiary of the company, from Lucas-TVS Ltd, constituting 4.39 per cent of the paid-up share capital in TVSCS for an aggregate consideration of ₹711 crore (cash consideration). With this, the shareholding of TVS Motor in TVS Credit will increase from 80.76 per cent to 85.15 per cent (on fully diluted basis). OUR BUREAU

Suzlon picks Singapore as global hub to drive its overseas expansion

Avinash Nair

Ahmedabad

Wind turbine maker Suzlon Energy is setting up a wholly owned subsidiary in Singapore as a regional headquarters to steer its international business. The entity will anchor overseas sales, operations and governance as it targets a bigger presence in Europe, Australia and parts of Asia.

The proposal, approved by its board on Tuesday, goes beyond creating another overseas subsidiary. According to Suzlon Group CEO Ajay Kapur, the Singapore office will function as the group's international control centre, overseeing overseas sales, operations and maintenance services, banking and procurement, while also serving as the base for its European operations.

"We are not looking at putting a very big headcount there. This will be more of a controlling office under which international sales can happen. It is for better governance and better tax planning," Kapur told *businessline* on Tuesday.

He said Singapore was chosen because it offers an efficient structure to service Suzlon's growing international business.

"In order to service various countries and also for having better banking facilities and procurement facilities for international markets, we had to choose one geography to become the headquarters under which we can have country operations," he added.

The company is targeting about 3 GW of international business by FY31, including around 1 GW of annual overseas sales, as it seeks to rebuild its global presence in markets where Suzlon had previously installed turbines.

"One of the goals we have set is to start going to international markets, especially

L&T profit rises 14%, led by energy and realty biz

PROJECTS DELAYED. But company confident of winning more orders from West Asia

Aneesh Phadnis

Mumbai

Larsen & Toubro posted a 14 per cent year-on-year increase in consolidated net profit at ₹4,123 crore in Q1FY27 on the back of stable performance in its energy and realty businesses. Lower finance costs and treasury income also boosted the results.

ORDER BOOK

In the quarter, the company bagged ₹1.08 lakh crore worth orders across segments, a growth of 14 per cent over the previous year. Revenue growth, however, was slower as its projects were impacted by supply chain disruptions caused

Scorecard		
	Q1FY27	Q1FY26
Revenue from operations	67,942	63,679
EBITDA	6,116	6,318
Net profit	4,123	3,617

by the West Asia crisis. Revenue in Q1FY27 rose 7 per cent to ₹67,942 crore on a year-on-year basis. EBITDA declined 3 per cent to ₹6,116 crore, and margins were lower because of execution challenges and project mix.

"The financial year has commenced against the backdrop of geopolitical uncertainties. The company has managed to maintain momentum by rotating its focus across sectors and geographies while maintaining robust cash flows.

The performance for the quarter reflects our portfolio resilience," said SN Subrahmanyam, Chairman and Managing Director.

GULF ORDERS

While the offshore energy contract in Europe contributed the largest share of order value in the first quarter, West Asia remains a promising region for the company, said President and whole-time director (finance) R Shankar Raman. Orders from Saudi Arabia and the

UAE contributed 20 per cent of total order wins in the first quarter.

Raman said project execution in the region has been delayed due to disruption in Strait of Hormuz, resulting in escalation in project costs. While the company is taking steps to mitigate the challenge by improved sourcing and hedging, it is confident that customers will reimburse the higher costs incurred in project execution.

"All our sites are safe. All our people working there are safe. We didn't pack our bags and leave," said Raman, referring to the conflict.

He said the company is confident of winning more orders from the region from reconstruction and upgrade projects.

Ambuja Cement Q1 profit down 37% on weak realisation, fall in production

Our Bureau

Mumbai

Ambuja Cement, part of the Adani Group, reported that its net profit in the June quarter of FY27 was down 37 per cent at ₹660 crore, against ₹1,041 crore logged in the same period last year, on lower realisation and fall in production.

Revenue was down at ₹9,474 crore (₹10,244 crore). Sales volume dipped 8 per cent to 17 million tonnes (18.4 mt).

FREIGHT COSTS FALL

Overall expenses were down at ₹8,802 crore (₹9,162 crore) on the back of fall in power and freight cost at

Scorecard		
	Q1 FY26	Q1 FY27
Net profit (₹ cr)	1,041	660
Revenue (₹ cr)	10,244	9,474
EPS (Diluted) (₹)	3.53	2.32

₹2,389 crore (₹2,513 crore) and ₹2,258 crore (₹2,423 crore). EBITDA per tonne was down at ₹931 (₹1,069).

The company expects to increase overall capacity to 119 mtpa by FY27.

Ambuja Cement has commenced trial production at Dahej (1.2 mtpa), Salai Banwa (2.4 mtpa), Bathinda (1.2 mtpa) and Jodhpur (2

mtpa). It will commission units at Kalamboli (1 mtpa) and Warisaliganj (2.4 mtpa) next year, and the Maratha clinker line (4 mtpa) will be commissioned in 2027.

On a standalone basis, the company's net profit was down 37 per cent at ₹504 crore (₹797 crore), while revenue was up 3 per cent at ₹6,328 crore (₹6,148 crore). Sales volume was up 2 per cent at 11.7 mt (11.5 mt). EBITDA per tonne was down 10 per cent at ₹797 (₹887).

Vinod Bahtey, Whole Time Director and CEO, Ambuja Cement, said higher trade sales and an increased share of premium products strengthened the market mix, resulting in improved

profitability and quality of earnings.

WEST ASIA WAR

Despite temporary cost headwinds arising from the West Asia geopolitical tensions, the company delivered a sequential cost reduction of ₹206 a tonne through operational excellence, improved energy efficiency, lower clinker factor and disciplined cost management.

This resulted in a 331 bps q-o-q expansion in EBITDA margin at 16.7 per cent. The company is also firmly on course to deliver cost reduction of about ₹250 per tonne to achieve targeted cost of ₹4,250 a tonne by the end of FY27.

Suzlon Energy Q1 profit falls 6%

Our Bureau

Ahmedabad

Suzlon Energy Ltd reported a six per cent year-on-year decline in consolidated net profit at ₹305 crore for the June quarter, even as revenue from operations grew 23 per cent on the back of higher deliveries and strong execution.

The wind energy major's revenue from operations rose to ₹3,819 crore in the first quarter of FY27, from ₹3,117 crore in the year-ago period. EBITDA stood at ₹595 crore, broadly unchanged from ₹599 crore a year earlier, while EBITDA margin moderated to 15.6 per cent from 19.2 per cent.

The company did not provide a detailed breakup for the decline in profitability, but said margins were impacted by temporary logistics disruptions arising from geopolitical developments, strategic investments and changes in the scope and

Scorecard			
	Q1FY26	Q1FY27	% change
Revenue from operations	3,117	3,819	22.5
Net profit	324	305	(-6)

segment mix. The renewable energy solutions segment, which now includes the company's wind energy solutions business along with emerging renewable energy offerings, reported a 27 per cent growth in revenue during the quarter.

The RE asset management services segment recorded an 8 per cent increase, while the foundry and forging business seeing revenue growth of 14 per cent.

RECORD ORDERS

Suzlon reported its highest-ever Q1 deliveries at 506 MW, up 14 per cent year-on-year, while commissioning more than doubled to 269 MW in the quarter, compared with 116 MW in Q1 FY26. The company also se-

cured record new orders of around 1 GW in the quarter, including two large developer-led EPC orders from Tata Power and Waaree Group. Its cumulative order book stood at around 6.1 GW, with 84 per cent of orders coming from the PSU and commercial & industrial segments.

"Our strong start to FY27 reflects disciplined execution across every aspect of our business. We achieved our highest-ever first quarter deliveries of 506 MW, up 14 per cent year-on-year, while more than doubling our commissioning as projects moved into advanced stages of execution," stated Ajay Kapur, Chief Executive Officer, Suzlon Group, in an official release.

Varun Beverages sees 15% rise in net profit

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani

New Delhi

Varun Beverages, leading bottler of PepsiCo, posted a consolidated net profit of ₹1,525.3 crore, up 15.1 per cent in the June quarter over ₹1,325.49 crore. Net revenues grew 20.4 per cent to ₹8,451.23 crore.

The company's board approved an interim dividend of 25 per cent per equity share, resulting in a total cash outflow of about ₹1,69.1 crore.

Ravi Jaipuria, Chairman, Varun Beverages, said: "We have extended our exclusive bottling and trademark licence agreement with PepsiCo in India until April 2049, and removed the earlier restriction requiring VBL to operate solely as an SPV for PepsiCo's business, strengthening our long-term partnership and creating greater operational flexibil-



ity to pursue opportunities that can deliver scale and synergies."

The company said its consolidated sales volume grew by 19.8 per cent to 466.7 million cases in Q2CY26. The company follows January-December as the financial period.

"In India, we saw healthy volume growth in twenties since the onset of season from March onwards, except for April which was about flat, resulting in overall volume growth for the

quarter of 14.4 per cent," he said, adding that the company expects to witness double-digit growth in the second half of the year.

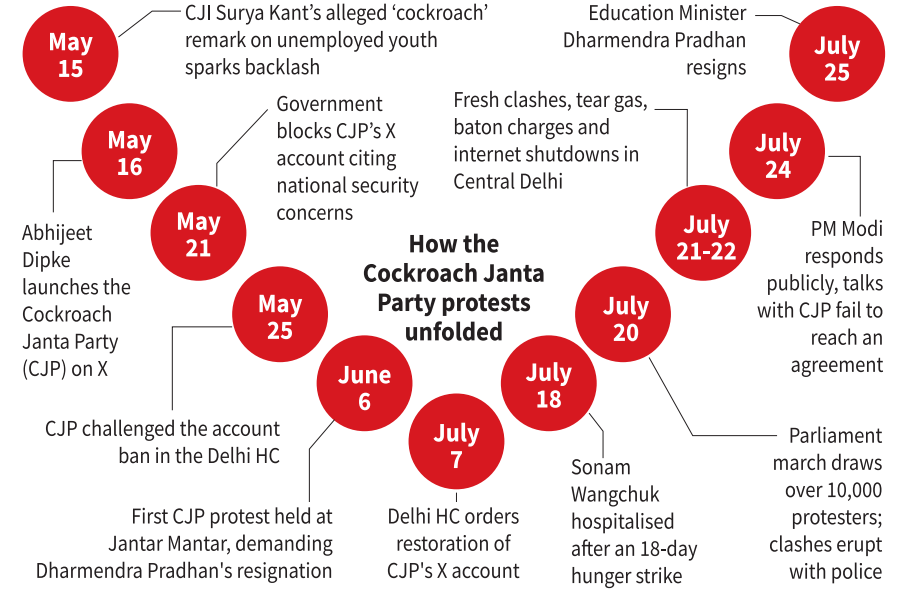
ENERGY DRINKS

On the impact of FSSAI's direction for removal of energy drinks descriptor from products such as Sting, Jaipuria said in the earnings call: "They have come out with a clear guideline that we should remove the word energy from the labels within 90 days... They just want the word energy to be taken away which does not change anything for us... We saw a temporary dip in June and July in the energy mix... but now the new labels are out in the market for us... So, we are seeing uptick in volumes back for Sting."

Responding to a query on the impact of geopolitical tensions, he said: "In India, early stocking of key raw materials and savings in sugar

VISUALLY.

Compiled by Yashaswani Chauhan | Graphic KS Gunasekar



Students have shaped many of India's defining protest movements

Major student-led protests in India since 2006

Protest/Movement name	Year	Trigger
Anti-Reservation Protests (Youth for Equality)	2006	27% OBC quota in premier institutions like IITs, IIMs and AIIMS
Telangana Student Agitation (OU JAC)	2009	Demand for a separate Telangana State, led by Osmania University students
FTII Agitation	2015	Opposition to Gajendra Chauhan appointment as FTII Chairman
Justice for Rohith Movement	2016	Systemic discrimination faced by Dalit students, sparked by the suicide of Rohith Vemula
Jallikattu Youth Protests	2017	Demand to restore Jallikattu after the Supreme Court ban
Anti-CAA / NRC Campus Protests	2019-2020	Opposition to the Citizenship Amendment Act and proposed NRC
Youth-led Exam Reform (Cockroach Janta Party) Protests (India)	2026	Repeated exam leaks, student suicides and youth unemployment

Gen Z is reshaping protest politics across South Asia

Major student-led protest movements

Country (Protest/movement)	Year	Trigger
Pakistan (The Student Solidarity March)	2019	Decades-long ban on student unions; address campus sexual harassment
Sri Lanka (Aragalaya)	2022	Economic crisis and corruption
Bangladesh (Anti-Quota Movement)	2024	Government job quota system
Pakistan (Baloch Students' Protest)	2024-2025	Enforced disappearances; education rights
Nepal (Student Anti-Corruption Protests)	2025	Corruption and governance concerns

Student movements have repeatedly changed governments and policies

Landmark student-led protests around the world

Country (Protest/movement)	Year	Trigger
US (Vietnam War Protests)	1960s-1973	Opposition to the Vietnam War
South Africa (Soweto Uprising)	1976	Apartheid education policies
Czechoslovakia (Velvet Revolution)	1989	Opposition to communist rule
Ukraine (Euromaidan)	2013-14	Suspension of EU association agreement
Hong Kong (Umbrella Movement)	2019	Extradition bill and democratic freedoms

Source: Media reports

Radico Khaitan profit jumps 76% to ₹230 crore

Press Trust of India

New Delhi

Radico Khaitan on Tuesday reported a 76 per cent year-on-year rise in consolidated net profit at ₹229.60 crore in the June quarter of FY27. The home-grown liquor major posted a consolidated net

profit of ₹130.52 crore in the April-June period a year ago, the company said in a BSE filing.

The company, which owns brands such as Rampur Indian Single Malt Whisky, Jaisalmer Indian Craft Gin, Magic Moments Vodka and the 8 PM series, reported revenue from operations of

₹5,867.69 crore in Q1FY27, up 13.22 per cent from ₹5,182.30 crore in the corresponding quarter of the preceding fiscal.

During the quarter, Radico Khaitan delivered its "highest ever volume, top line and profitability", the company said in its earnings statement.

Coca-Cola says volume growth strong in India

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani

New Delhi

Coca-Cola said it views India as a long-term growth opportunity, where it is focusing on meeting consumer needs by leveraging on its revenue growth management capabilities.

The company, which released its Q2 CY2026 earnings, said it is not only seeing opportunities in the affordable segment, but also in the premium-end.

Responding to a query on the Asia-Pacific and India region, Henrique Braun, CEO of The Coca-Cola Company, said: "It is a long-term opportunity and continues to be very attractive to us, and we continue to build this for the future... We have said in the past that this will be the place where we're going to continue to invest ahead of the curve, bringing more

consumers to the base in the right way, tightening up our revenue growth management capabilities; it's a place where we're seeing not only opportunities in the affordability part, where we are investing ahead of the curve, but also in the premunisation side as well."

"We do own in India specifically seven out of the top ten brands today, and building the equity of those brands is our primary goal, and it's important that we continue to focus to build those capabilities to capture even more growth in the future," said Braun.

He noted that in terms of the Asia-Pacific region, India and China are outgrowing more developed markets such as Australia, Japan and Korea.

"We had great volume growth not only in India, but in China as well," he added.

Base effect

Schooling holds the key to education reform

In recent times, India’s higher education system has been in the spotlight for unfortunate reasons. The recently released Unified District Information System for Education Plus (UDISE+) does not paint a flattering picture of school education either. A poor foundation does skew access to learning at the higher level. The UDISE+ report covers over 14.8 lakh schools, 1.02 crore teachers and 26 crore students.



There can be no denying the improvement in basic metrics such as Gross Enrolment Ratio, retention ratio and pupil-teacher ratio in recent years, but the overall situation is deeply unsatisfactory. Thousands of schools operate with no students, while others manage with a single teacher saddled with multi-grade classrooms. Though zero-enrolment schools have dropped from 7,993 the previous year, they remain stubbornly high at 5,663. At the same time, the number of institutions compelled to function under a single-teacher still exceeds one lakh.

Some States have done well on these two metrics, notably Assam, Nagaland, and Tripura in the North East, as well as Telangana and Himachal Pradesh. West Bengal stands out as a stark example of failure, accounting for 4,133 zero-enrolment schools that hold 19,502 teachers hostage to empty classrooms. This is a case of public money being wasted to pay teachers who have no students to instruct. The State also houses 6,769 single-teacher schools catering to 2.3 lakh children. Andhra Pradesh has a different version of this mismatch; while it has very few zero-enrolment schools, it has a staggering 16,357 single-teacher schools. In Jharkhand and Maharashtra, hundreds of thousands of students are left at the mercy of understaffed setups. The pupil-to-teacher ratio of 24:1 at the national level is a mere statistic for students who have to contend with a single teacher handling multiple grades. States are yet to act decisively on school rationalisation through mergers or teacher redeployments. The 20,667 teachers in schools without enrolments must be redeployed in schools that have only one teacher. Where quality multi-grade teaching is absent, high dropout rates at the secondary and higher secondary level are an unsurprising consequence — a friction point evident in the 7 per cent dropout rate at the secondary level nationally, the highest across educational levels. However, the impact of commercialisation on drop-out and retention rates should be taken into account as well. The paucity of teachers in some States may be a result of a fiscal squeeze, driven by revenue deficit reduction.

As a result, teachers going solo have to handle pedagogy, administration, and mid-day meal operations. Finally, decent schooling is a universal right, and it has broadly been established that the state alone can combine both access and quality. The southern States have done better in this respect. The prevailing discontent over the education system cannot be addressed without going right back to schools.

OTHER VOICES.

The Guardian

Europe’s wildfires: politics must catch up with new reality
Anew and ominous word has entered the vocabulary of firefighters struggling to cope with the vast wildfire sweeping through south-west France. A pyrocumulonimbus is a fire-generated thunderstorm that can whip up winds in unpredictable ways, making the containment of a blaze and assessment of its likely course far more difficult. A known phenomenon in North America and Australia, firefighters believe France is suffering its first in the Bordeaux region, as the country endures the consequences of the third major heatwave of the summer and prepares for a fourth. The dire statistics of the ongoing fires in France and Spain tell a story of deepening devastation and human misery. A far greater expanse of French land has already been burnt this year, compared with the 30,000 hectares during the whole of 2025, while 220,000 people have been evacuated from their homes in the Gironde. LONDON, JULY 27

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.
EUROPE

The White House Missile Shortage Excuse
A remarkable thing happened this weekend with too little attention: In the middle of a war with Iran, officials in the Trump Administration leaked to the press that the U.S. is running out of ammunition. That was the explanation officials offered CNN and other news outlets for President Trump’s decision to stop his nightly bombing of Iran over its closure of the Strait of Hormuz. Mull over that one. Mr. Trump was saying all last week he is prepared for a major military escalation. But, suddenly, the leakers undermine the credibility of that U.S. resolve by telling the press—and thus the Iranians—that the U.S. can’t sustain the fight. NEW YORK, JULY 27



G VENKAT RAMAN

Last week, the Trump administration warned that China’s artificial intelligence start-up Moonshot could be added to the US Entity List over allegations of intellectual property theft.

At first glance, the episode appeared to be another chapter in the intensifying US-China technology rivalry. Yet it pointed to a more fundamental transformation in the relationship between governments and business.

States are no longer merely regulating markets; they are increasingly using economic, technological, and industrial policies to pursue national security objectives. As a result, business leaders can no longer treat geopolitics as a distant concern. It has become a structural force shaping corporate strategy.

At the heart of this transformation is a fundamental change in how governments understand economic power. In an era where technological leadership, supply chains, data, and critical infrastructure increasingly determine national strength, economic policy and national security are no longer separate domains. Artificial intelligence, semiconductors, and critical minerals increasingly shape military capability, technological sovereignty, and industrial competitiveness.

As commercial capabilities acquire strategic significance, governments are intervening more actively through industrial policy, export controls, investment screening, and technology regulation to secure national advantage. The objective is no longer simply to improve economic performance, but to strengthen national competitiveness and strategic autonomy. Business did not suddenly become geopolitical. Rather, national security has expanded into domains once regarded as purely commercial.

‘CRITICAL’ FIRMS

Few developments illustrate this transformation better than the strategic importance of a handful of firms that occupy critical positions in global technology and industrial value chains. Taiwan’s TSMC is no longer simply the world’s leading semiconductor manufacturer; its advanced fabrication capability has become central to Taiwan’s strategic importance and the resilience of global technology supply chains.

The Netherlands’ ASML occupies an equally strategic position as the only company capable of producing the extreme ultraviolet lithography machines required to manufacture cutting-edge chips. The US increasingly treats NVIDIA’s advanced AI processors as strategic technologies, restricting their exports on national security grounds.

China, meanwhile, views CATL not merely as the world’s largest electric



GETTY IMAGES

vehicle battery producer but as a national champion supporting its ambitions in advanced manufacturing and clean technologies. These firms operate in different industries and political systems. Yet they reveal the same defining reality: corporate capabilities have become strategic national assets.

What distinguishes these firms is not merely their market leadership but their control over capabilities that are difficult to replicate. Their technologies shape the competitiveness of entire industries, giving governments strong incentives to protect them and, where necessary, restrict access to them. Corporate capabilities have become inseparable from national strategic interests.

This shift is reshaping decision-making inside the boardroom. Decisions once evaluated primarily through the lens of cost, efficiency and shareholder returns now require a broader strategic assessment. Investment decisions increasingly account for geopolitical exposure alongside financial returns. Technology choices are influenced by export controls, sanctions risks and regulatory uncertainty. Partnerships, acquisitions, and market expansion strategies are evaluated not only for their commercial value but also for the strategic dependencies they may create. The logic of globalisation itself is changing.

CEOs can no longer treat geopolitics as an external risk delegated to government relations or compliance teams. Geopolitics must become integral to strategic decision-making

The objective is no longer to build the lowest-cost global value chain, but one that can absorb shocks and adapt quickly to changing geopolitical conditions. Decisions once left to operations or procurement increasingly require board-level oversight. Even manufacturing locations, sourcing strategies and supplier ecosystems are now shaped by political risk. In this environment, resilience has become a strategic capability rather than merely an operational concern. It is no longer simply the ability to recover from disruption, but the capacity to anticipate geopolitical shocks, absorb their impact and adapt before they undermine competitiveness.

INDIAN RESPONSE

Indian companies are already responding to this changing strategic environment. Procurement decisions, once driven primarily by cost, quality, and delivery schedules, increasingly incorporate geopolitical considerations. A manufacturing executive recently told me that some European customers now ask whether critical machine components contain Chinese inputs — not because of concerns over quality, but because supply chains themselves have acquired strategic significance. Indeed, even procurement decisions are shaped by geopolitical considerations.

Another executive noted that even industrial encoders, once regarded as routine engineering inputs, are now scrutinised by country of origin as firms seek to reduce strategic dependencies. In India’s electric vehicle industry, Tata Motors has focused on strengthening domestic technological capabilities, while JSW has pursued partnerships with Chinese firms to accelerate technological access. These represent different strategic responses, but both recognise

that firms now operate in a marketplace where geopolitical considerations shape competitive strategy. Efficiency remains essential, but it is no longer sufficient.

CEOs can no longer treat geopolitics as an external risk delegated to government relations or compliance teams. Geopolitics must become integral to strategic decision-making. As geopolitical developments reshape the commercial environment, senior corporate leaders must understand government priorities, regulatory trajectories and strategic competition when making decisions on investment, innovation, partnerships, and international expansion.

While firms retain strategic autonomy, the range of commercially viable choices is increasingly constrained by geopolitical realities. In some sectors, senior executives may also find themselves under growing pressure to align major investment, technology, and market decisions with their governments’ national security priorities. Leaders need the judgment to understand how geopolitical developments influence markets, technologies, investment decisions, and supply chains, and how policy shifts in one part of the world can reshape competitive conditions elsewhere. Building this capability also requires organisations to develop systems that monitor geopolitical developments, assess strategic vulnerabilities, and incorporate political risk into corporate planning.

In an era where national security shapes markets, firms that outperform will be those whose leaders integrate geopolitical judgment into business strategy.

The writer is Professor, Humanities and Social Sciences, IIM Indore

FCNR(B) scheme: Banks need to be prepared

These deposits pose a concentration risk if they attract just a set of high networth NRIs. This heightens liquidity risk as well

Manas R Das

The ‘special’ FCNR(B) scheme with concessional swap facility was operationalised on June 8. The RBI Governor, in an interview to this newspaper (July 27), said banks have mobilised \$32 billion so far.

Going by this trend, the total mobilisation will surpass the target of \$50-70 billion by September 30, when the scheme ends.

Banks are also likely to step on the gas as the deadline nears. More importantly, since NRIs are awaiting the US Fed rate decision in mid-September, FCNR(B) deposit inflows will likely accelerate towards September-end. Reportedly, there is 70 per cent possibility that the US Fed will hike the rates.

Although the RBI did not publish bank-wise data, it is quite likely that those with relatively large overseas network (including in IFSC GIFT City) will garner more deposits.

The ‘special’ FCNR(B) scheme has three pillars: (a) higher than normal interest rate, (b) zero-cost swap facility for fresh FCNR(B) deposits mobilised, including deposits renewed upon maturity, for 3-5 years’ tenor and (c) loan facility to the FCNR(B) depositors,

or issuance of Standby Letters of Credit in favour of overseas lenders, against FCNR(B) deposits mobilised.

Although media discussions have so far focused on the interest rate and the zero-cost swap facility aspects of the scheme, the emerging risks, for banks, from likely disbursement of substantial amount of loans to the FCNR(B) account holders have received little attention.

This article discusses scenarios under which banks will likely be exposed to many risks.

LIKELY RISKS

Liquidity risk: Against the backdrop of eroded income base of NRIs in general and those in the US and Middle-East in particular, it is quite likely that the ‘special’ FCNR(B) deposits may be accumulated through the leveraging facility by the high-net worth NRIs, which may fuel ‘concentration’ risk.

The ‘concentration’ risk, in turn, may have implications for ‘liquidity’ risk, if the depositor-borrowers intend to withdraw their deposits, prematurely. After the one-year lock-in, or want to repay their loans, fully or partly. This seems plausible if the global interest rates move upwards, particularly after the US Fed increases its rates.



BANKS. To remain vigilant

In such situations, lenders may have to quickly mobilise funds leading to a scramble for liquidity which, in a volatile market, may not be easy.

Banks, no doubt, will earn penalty amount for premature withdrawals, but it should be sufficient to defray the costs of securing liquidity at short notice, at market rates. Therefore, strict conditions may be stipulated to mitigate ‘premature withdrawal’ risk.

Default risk: The ‘lien’ on deposits protects lending banks from ‘default’ risk on the principal, but not on the interest due, which may also be substantial, and ruling out no borrower defaulting on timely interest servicing would be too ideal a situation. Timely

servicing could falter due to several reasons, especially in today’s volatile global conditions.

Without close monitoring, the risk of loan diversion for purposes other than buying FCNR(B) deposits remains a possibility.

ALM risk: Three to five years tenor of the ‘special’ FCNR(B) deposits, coupled with the likely premature withdrawal risk, makes ‘Asset Liability Mismatch’ risk probable.

MANAGING THE RISKS

It is hoped that banks have appropriately considered the risks discussed above as well as other risks, if any, while pricing the loans. Otherwise, their ‘net interest income’ will be stressed, and in order to protect it if they consider reducing domestic deposit rates, it may be inequitable to domestic depositors and be viewed unfavourably.

That said, the RBI’s step is an extraordinary move aimed at protecting the country’s external sector from the challenging global conditions and, therefore, accommodating the risks is a *sine qua non* for the entire banking sector.

The writer is a former Assistant General Manager (Economist), SBI. Views expressed are personal

✉ **LETTERS TO EDITOR** Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

A prudent move
Apropos, ‘To cut import dependence on urea, Govt allows ammonia for farming’, (July 28), the government’s initiative to permit the use of ammonia in agriculture as a substitute for urea is a prudent policy intervention. Facilitating ammonia-based fertilization can enhance nutrient-use efficiency, strengthen agricultural self-sufficiency, and alleviate fiscal pressures. However, successful implementation

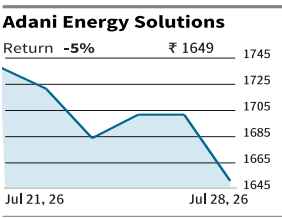
necessitates stringent safety standards, farmer sensitisation, and robust distribution infrastructure due to ammonia’s hazardous nature. If executed with scientific rigour and regulatory oversight, this reform can substantially bolster India’s fertilizer security.
N Sadhasiva Reddy
Bengaluru
Medicare access
The Editorial ‘NEET revamp’ (July 28) hits all the right notes. Beyond

the apparently broken examination system are other concerns. The poor doctor-patient ratio is one. The state must play the lead role in establishing many new colleges and step up allocation for public health. This could regulate the quality and cost of medical education. Alongside, AYUSH sector must be encouraged. There needs to be proper regulation, licensing, and transparency of the sector and its practitioners, supported by state funded research. This will ensure
quality medicare reaches the underserved at affordable cost.
V Vijaykumar
Pune
NEET: Revamp character
Apropos ‘NEET revamp’ (July 28). Paper leaks are not isolated incidents; they are driven by greed and the pursuit of shortcuts to achieve success, with stakeholders extending far beyond any single section of society. While a Bill introduced in Parliament

seeks stringent action, its implementation could still be undermined by those involved in such leaks, raising a larger concern. Unless the character of future generations is transformed, no law or punishment can deter such corrupt intentions. Let this Guru Purnima mark the beginning of a resolve to transform ourselves before expecting others to change.
Rajiv Magal
Halekere Village (Karnataka)

QUICKLY.

Adani Energy's ₹3,500 cr QIP oversubscribed 3x



Mumbai: Adani Energy Solutions reported that its qualified institutional placement to raise ₹3,500 crore was oversubscribed three times as it closed on Tuesday. It received investment interest of ₹10,800 crore with strong participation from mutual funds and insurance companies. The issue had no green shoe option. The company will issue about 21.7 million shares at the base issue size. The QIP, priced at ₹1,615 a piece, opened for subscription on Monday. The floor price as per SEBI formula was at ₹1,698.15 per share. The company has offered a discount of 5.18 per cent to the Monday's closing prices of ₹1,703. The company intends to use the proceeds from QIP for capital expenditure, repayment of loans and future acquisition. **OUR BUREAU**

Meenakshi India lists on BSE, jumps 5% to ₹296.08

New Delhi: Apparel maker Meenakshi India on Tuesday completed its price discovery process and officially commenced trading on the BSE main board, with the stock debuting at ₹281.99. The stock opened at ₹281.99 and closed at 5 per cent upper circuit limit at ₹296.08. Further, a total of 1.125 crore shares were listed on the BSE. The company will remain listed on the Calcutta Stock Exchange. In a statement, the Tamil Nadu-based company said it plans to invest around ₹40 crore to expand its manufacturing capacity from about 18 lakh garments annually to nearly 35 lakh by FY30. **PTI**

Zepto to allot ₹2,298 cr for anchor book in IPO

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

Quick commerce firm Zepto has earmarked ₹2,298 crore for anchor investors as part of its proposed ₹5,106-crore initial public offering (IPO), people familiar with the development said.

The company has begun discussions with prospective anchor investors while targeting a post-money valuation of around ₹29,106 crore (\$3 billion).

According to the proposed deal contours, the IPO will comprise a fresh issue of ₹5,000 crore and an offer for sale (OFS) of about ₹106 crore.

The anchor portion, at ₹2,298 crore, accounts for nearly 45 per cent of the issue size.

\$3B VALUATION

The rest is proposed to be split into a ₹1,532 crore qualified institutional buyers (QIB) book, a ₹766 crore high-networth individual (HNI) portion, and a ₹511-

PMS net inflows surge to ₹3.55 lakh cr in June, AUM rises to ₹43.3 lakh cr

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The portfolio management services (PMS) industry recorded a sharp jump in net inflows to ₹3,54,755 crore in June 2026, recovering from ₹4,085 crore in May, driven by discretionary mandates.

The improved flow momentum helped lift the industry's assets under management (AUM) by 1.8 per cent, or about ₹77,700 crore, to ₹43.27 lakh crore at the end of June from ₹42.49 lakh crore in May. AUM growth also accelerated from 0.5 per cent in May to 1.8 per cent in June.

CLIENT GROWTH

The industry's client base grew 4 per cent during the month to around 2.2 lakh accounts, reflecting continued investor participation, ac-

South Korea, Japan meltdown barely ruffles India; IT stocks steal the show

MAINTAINING RESILIENCE. Nifty 50 closes flat while Nifty IT index rallies 3.3%, led by Coforge

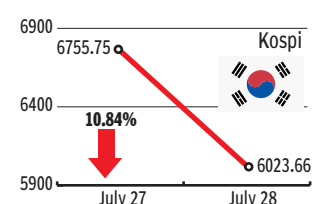
Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

While South Korea's Kospi plunged 11 per cent and Japan's Nikkei fell nearly 4 per cent amid a global semiconductor sell-off on Tuesday, Indian markets shrugged off the turbulence and ended almost flat, with IT stocks surging on the back of relatively better earnings. The falling crude oil prices and appreciation in rupee also helped in market sentiment.

The Nifty 50 closed at 23,985, down just 0.04 per cent, on what was also a monthly F&O expiry day, a session typically marked by choppiness. However, declines outnumbered advances by nearly 2:1, yet the index held its ground.

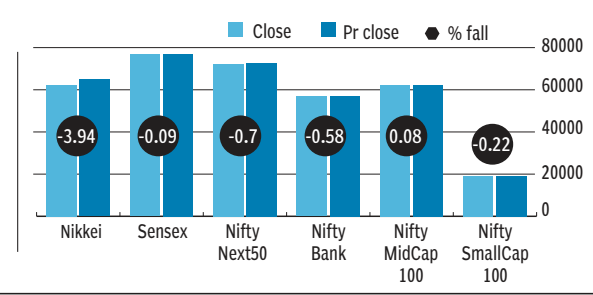
“Asian chip stocks told a

Shock & Awe



different story. South Korean names like SK Hynix fell sharply on rising concerns about Chinese semiconductor competition... Indian IT services and Asian chip manufacturing are not the same trade. One is under pressure. The other is proving its value,” said Sarvam Goel, Founder, Pocketful.

According to Siddhartha Khemka - Head of Research, Wealth Management,



Motilal Oswal Financial Services Ltd, Investor sentiment weakened (in Korea and Japan markets) following concerns over rising AI infrastructure spending after reports that Nvidia is in discussions to provide financial support for OpenAI's large-scale data centre expansion. In contrast, the Nifty IT index rallied 3.3 per cent as Indian IT companies are viewed as relatively insu-

lated from the capital-intensive AI investment cycle.

COFORGE SURGES

Coforge led the charge, jumping 10 per cent after reporting 33 per cent year-on-year revenue growth in dollar terms, with 86 per cent of revenues now coming from AI-led engineering, data and cloud services. The IT sector has now gained nearly 16 per cent from its recent lows.

On the losing side, HUL tumbled 7 per cent after reporting weaker-than-expected earnings, profits dipped despite 10 per cent revenue growth, pointing to margin pressure. Varun Beverages also fell 7 per cent as Q1 volume growth missed consensus estimates. FMCG and energy stocks broadly remained under pressure.

Brent crude oil prices which passed \$100/barrel a few days back, fell to around \$85, while rupee gained 11 paise on Tuesday.

Looking ahead, markets will track the Fed and Bank of Japan policy outcomes this week. “Given the mixed global backdrop... we continue to advocate a selective, stock-specific approach, preferring auto and pharma,” said Ajit Mishra, SVP Research, Religare Broking.

MF-only PMS plan puts focus on value beyond fund management

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

SEBI's proposal to create a dedicated mutual fund-only portfolio management Service (MF-PMS) category seeks to carve out a new space between traditional portfolio management and investment advisory, with portfolio managers saying the product's differentiation will lie in discretionary portfolio management, asset allocation and execution.

The regulator has a separate registration category under which portfolio managers would exclusively manage investments in the direct plans of mutual funds, exchange-traded funds (ETFs) and specialised in-

vestment funds (SIFs).

Bhavin Shah, Founder and Portfolio Manager at Sameeksha Capital and a board member of the Association of Portfolio Managers in India (APMI), said, “It is not clear what gap it serves because MF-PMS is already possible through the regular PMS route... The question is what incremental value do they add over what they are already able to do.”

COST TO GO UP

SEBI has proposed that the same client cannot be serviced through the distribution mode as well as through the MF PMS mode even if these two services are segregated by the company offering both. “So any wealth manager/MF distribu-



wanting to offer MF PMS to their existing clients on-boarded through the regular mode of MFs will have to convince the client to switch completely from the distributor mode account to MF PMS,” he said.

The proposed fee structure also results in investors bearing both the underlying MF expense ratio and the PMS management fee, he said.

Biharilal Deora, Chairman of APMI, said the value proposition lies in discretionary portfolio management rather than access to mutual funds alone. The framework is aimed at investors with sizeable MF portfolios, who want professional asset allocation, fund selection, execution and portfolio rebalancing, without having to make every investment decision themselves, he said.

“Its value would be evident in customised risk-based portfolio construction and ongoing risk management, rather than merely packaging a basket of popular MFs, making it far superior to traditional FOF,” Deora said. APMI is preparing its representation on the draft paper and is expected to seek

clarifications on disclosures, conflict-of-interest safeguards, client suitability, corpus and net-worth requirements before the framework is finalised, Deora said.

Sandeep Jethwani, Co-founder of Dezerv said, “It introduces a tailored subcategory for mass-affluent investors who prioritise direct plans and low costs, but wish to offload the entire operational burden to a manager who holds a discretionary mandate.”

Jethwani said the relaxed eligibility norms could also expand the provider base, estimating that 15-18 per cent of registered investment advisers could become eligible for a portfolio manager licence under the proposed framework.

BROKER'S CALL.

Investec

SUNTECH REALTY (BUY)

Target: ₹494
CMP: ₹307.10
Sunteck Realty reported 20 per cent y-o-y pre-sales growth to ₹790 crore in Q1-FY27, driven by healthy booking momentum across its portfolio, particularly at Vasai, Mira Road and Naigaon. Collections were up 17 per cent y-o-y to ₹410 crore, in line with pre-sales growth, however collection to pre-sales ratio was flat at 52 per cent in Q1-FY27 (vs 53 per cent y-o-y). Management highlighted that demand continues to be strong across all its micro-markets and on the pre-sales concluded in FY26 and Q1FY27, embedded margins on these projects was in the range of 35-40 per cent. Net OCF before business development (BD) came in at ₹190 crore (+78 per cent y-o-y), and the company spent ₹170 crore towards BD/JDA cost. Sunteck has unsold inventory of ₹8,400 crore across ongoing projects and has un-launched inventory pipeline of ₹38,300 crore which provides healthy pre-sales visibility going ahead. This pipeline offers 3-4 years of launch visibility, and the company plans launches totalling ₹7,100 crore GDV over the next three quarters across Andheri, Vasai, Naigaon, Goregaon and Mira Road. With strong inventory pipeline, we expect Sunteck to register pre-sales growth of 27 per cent CAGR over FY26-28E. Furthermore, cashflows are expected to remain strong on back healthy construction progress. We retain our Buy on Sunteck with a TP of ₹494 as the stock trades at attractive level of 0.6x of NAV. **Key Risks:** Sluggish macro, weak launches, slow sales momentum.

Equirus Securities

CANARA BANK (LONG)

Target: ₹155
CMP: ₹124.30
Canara Bank reported an in-line Nil, with flattish NIMs at 2.52 per cent (lower end of the SOE bank NIM range). The 22 bps q-o-q CoF benefit was largely passed on to borrowers, resulting in a 29 bps q-o-q decline in yield on advances. The bank continues to replace bulk deposits with retail CASA and term deposits. Management currently sees 20-30 bps CoF benefits on incremental deposits, supporting NIMs in 2QFY27. It has guided to FY27 NIMs of 2.5-2.6 per cent and intends to improve the CASA ratio to drive medium-term margin expansion. CBK has mobilised \$775 million of FCNR(B) deposits, and targets total mobilisation of \$2.5 billion. Advances grew 5 per cent q-o-q, aided by healthy retail (+36 per cent y-o-y/+7 per cent q-o-q) and MSME (+15 per cent y-o-y/+7 per cent q-o-q) growth, while corporate advances grew 4 per cent q-o-q. Slippages moderated to 58bps (vs 94 bps q-o-q), while GNPA/NNPA ratios improved to 1.6/0.4 per cent (vs 1.8/0.4 per cent q-o-q). We expect FY27E RoA of about 1 per cent, supported by healthy PSCL fee income and sustained recoveries. However, near-term NIMs are likely to remain constrained, and we therefore build in flattish margins. Slippages are expected to stay in check. Sustained improvement in the liability franchise and NIM expansion, rather than incremental loan growth, will be the key catalysts for earnings upgrades and valuation re-rating. Retain Long with an unchanged Mar'27 TP of ₹155.

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TODAY'S PICK.

LTM (₹4,311.25): BUY

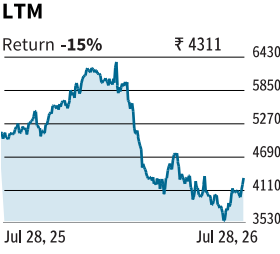
Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish on LTM. The 3 per cent rise on Tuesday has taken the share price well above the key resistance level of ₹4,200. It also confirms an inverted head and shoulder pattern.

This is a bullish pattern. Support will now be in the ₹4,200-₹4,150 region, which can limit the downside. The LTM share price can rise to ₹4,680 in the coming weeks.

Indeed, the target level of the inverted head and shoulder pattern comes much higher at ₹4,980. Traders can buy LTM shares now at ₹4,311.

Accumulate on dips at ₹4,260. Keep the stop-loss at



₹4,110 initially. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹4,385 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹4,465. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹4,480 and ₹4,540 when the price touches ₹4,530 and ₹4,600 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹4,660.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24120

» Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
24050	23900	24180	24300	Go long only on a break above 24180 with a stop-loss at 24120

₹737

» HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
732	728	740	750	Take fresh longs only above 740 with a stop-loss at 738

₹1105

» Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1100	1080	1120	1145	Go long on a bounce from 1100. Keep the stop-loss at 1095

₹285

» ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
285	280	286	289	Go long only above 285. Stop-loss can be kept at 285

₹238

» ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
236	231	241	243	Go short only below 236. Stop-loss can be placed at 237

₹1272

» Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1265	1250	1280	1300	Take fresh longs above 1280. Keep the stop-loss at 1275

₹1012

» SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1010	998	1020	1030	Go short only below 1010. Keep the stop-loss at 1015

₹2398

» TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2340	2310	2420	2455	Go long on a break above 2420. Keep the stop-loss at 2415

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers					▼ 10.60 pts.
	Close(t)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
TCS	2398.00	22.83	17.33	2.23	
HDFC MF	1105.70	20.30	14.79	3.53	
Infosys Ltd.	308.35	19.74	687.23	2.03	
Titan	4849.70	9.88	94.85	1.82	
Tech Mahindra	1635.20	8.35	31.04	0.95	
NestleIndia	1491.80	7.16	75.48	0.97	
L&T	3832.00	6.65	27.81	4.08	
M&M	3271.20	6.36	21.84	2.66	
HCL Tech	1318.60	5.23	20.52	1.27	
Bajaj Auto	11374.00	4.81	27.52	1.15	
Cipla	1444.60	4.33	34.78	0.71	
Asian Paints	2736.20	2.57	59.72	1.13	
SBI Life	1889.10	2.19	72.86	0.77	
Maruti Suzuki	13802.00	2.05	29.56	1.64	
Eicher Motors	7836.00	2.00	39.00	0.98	
Int'lGlobeVai	5270.50	2.00	0.00	1.09	
UltraTech Cement	11956.00	1.94	41.11	1.29	
Bajaj Finserv	1927.90	1.88	15.69	1.02	
Wipro	181.12	1.62	14.32	0.47	
HDFC Life	558.75	1.39	61.05	0.55	
Apollo Hosp	8903.00	1.34	63.92	0.83	
Kotak Bank	385.30	1.05	18.88	2.58	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	105.19	0.82	21.64	1.33	
Adani Ports	1774.70	0.69	31.99	1.19	
Sun Pharma	1976.70	0.69	41.21	1.91	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	237.08	0.65	75.76	0.71	
JSW Steel	1246.90	0.47	10.89	1.06	
Grasim Ind	3116.20	0.31	20.59	1.07	
ONGC	1288.91	0.30	6.04	0.85	
Bajaj Finance	1048.40	0.06	33.76	2.56	
Trent Ltd.	2930.70	-0.55	90.79	0.89	
Tata Motors PV	324.40	-1.48	3982.37	0.62	
Max Healthcare	1104.80	-1.59	74.54	0.75	
Dr Reddys Lab	1135.60	-2.02	29.78	0.63	
Adani Enter	3002.30	-2.16	39.25	0.79	
Bharti Airtel	1901.80	-2.32	34.26	5.27	
Axis Bank	1223.50	-2.51	13.62	3.20	
ITC	284.65	-2.53	16.97	2.50	
Hindalco	936.40	-2.80	15.71	1.23	
Tata Steel	1882.20	-2.92	20.94	1.37	
PowerGrid Corp	285.30	-3.51	16.66	1.18	
TataConsumerProduct	1082.10	-3.60	65.21	0.84	
State Bank	1013.20	-6.68	10.79	3.81	
NTPC	343.75	-7.30	11.76	1.48	
Coal India	410.15	-9.08	8.14	0.89	
HDFC Bank	735.40	-13.88	13.73	10.25	
Bharat Elec	389.00	-14.20	46.91	1.27	
Reliance Ind	1267.10	-18.15	19.46	7.80	
ICICI Bank	1430.80	-23.31	17.18	3.52	
Hind Unilever	2022.70	-29.43	44.91	1.63	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

▼ 509.40 pts.

	Close(t)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Macrotech Developers .	1301.40	82.80	31.49	1.46
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3993.50	79.94	52.68	3.78
Tata Motors Cv	416.70	33.99	50.68	3.51
Britannia Ind	5478.50	32.18	52.01	2.80
LtIntimtree	4309.20	31.96	24.60	1.61
United Spirits .	1508.80	23.01	65.05	1.80
Dif	663.05	22.65	37.18	1.71
Bpcl	320.05	22.38	8.11	2.61
Pidlifind	1619.60	7.47	66.72	1.92
Gail (India)	175.15	7.21	15.19	2.00
Hindustal Motor India .	2001.90	7.17	29.95	1.15
Tata Capital	354.95	6.44	30.81	0.72
Divis Lab	7425.00	6.06	76.76	3.80
Bajaj Holdings	10831.00	2.64	12.31	1.89
Indian Hotels Co .	734.70	2.42	45.30	2.60
Bosch	41310.00	1.51	43.93	1.44
Rural Elec	368.45	1.09	6.05	1.87
Shree Cement	26875.00	0.58	55.45	1.45
Punjab Natl Bank	111.65	0.30	5.80	1.55
Power Finance	419.90	-0.85	4.12	2.46
Indian Oilcorp	141.28	-2.61	4.57	2.13
Muthootfin	3014.40	-3.58	11.41	1.30
Hindus Zinc	526.30	-3.84	13.04	1.82
Indian Railway Finance Corp	87.15	-5.73	16.25	0.71
Zyduslifesiences	1099.20	-6.54	21.59	1.11
Mazagon Dock	2295.80	-7.62	33.61	0.70
Godrej Consumer	1066.90	-7.94	58.65	1.73
Ambuja Cements	426.00	-8.97	19.26	1.07
Siemens	3681.00	-9.50	85.52	1.31
Hindustaneronautics	460.00	-10.42	37.33	3.52
Union Bank	168.40	-10.50	6.22	1.31
Jindal Steel	1054.40	-12.16	39.71	1.57
Axis Bank	292.00	-12.56	36.83	2.08
Abb India	7243.50	-12.81	97.14	1.53
Samarvadhotsonotinterinfat	147.86	-14.22	38.20	2.63
Adaniireenenergy	3177.00	-21.31	106.75	1.86
Siemens Energy India .	1380.90	-21.54	86.49	1.13
Bank Of Baroda	225.00	-25.88	6.73	1.79
Axis Bank	292.00	-35.12	36.83	2.77
Solar Industries	18244.00	-27.18	95.06	1.91
Tata Power	371.35	-29.08	23.19	2.50
Canara Bank	124.24	-29.50	6.30	1.68
Cholamandalamini&Fin	1743.00	-40.48	28.56	3.04
Adani Energy Solutions	1659.50	-51.35	64.12	2.18
Corrent Pharma	408.94	-51.67	87.24	2.90
Cg Power & Ind Sol	844.16	-66.10	107.37	2.33
Commins India	5455.50	-68.30	64.03	2.97
Adani Power .	208.25	-68.85	27.63	3.48
Avenuesuper	3846.60	-84.81	82.06	2.50
Pariva Beverages .	430.00	-137.08	45.32	2.37

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

Northern Arc Capital posts Q1 profit of ₹114 cr



Mumbai: Northern Arc Capital Limited reported its highest-ever first-quarter profit on Monday, with profit after tax rising 41 per cent year-on-year to ₹114 crore in Q1FY27, even as its stock fell sharply on Tuesday following the announcement. Shares of the Mumbai-based non-banking financial company closed at ₹285.35 on the NSE on Tuesday, down 4.92 per cent from the previous close of ₹300.10, giving it a market capitalisation of approximately ₹4,639 crore. On the operational front, net interest income grew 32 per cent year-on-year to ₹394 crore, while pre-provision operating profit rose 27 per cent to ₹263 crore. Lending assets under management expanded 26 per cent year-on-year to ₹16,855 crore as of June 30, 2026. Direct-to-customer lending, which now accounts for 64 per cent of total AUM, grew faster at 51 per cent year-on-year to ₹10,766 crore. Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer Ashish Mehrotra flagged watchfulness around geopolitical risks in West Asia and potential El Niño disruptions. **OUR BUREAU**

Tata Power aims at ₹30,000 cr rooftop solar revenue by 2029

DRIVING DEMAND. Firm banks on govt policies, battery costs and consumer awareness

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

The Tata Power Company Ltd on Tuesday said it is targeting a more than six-fold jump in revenue from its rooftop solar business to ₹30,000 crore by 2029, while aiming to double its market share to nearly 25 per cent. “We have been growing at a very high pace. Year before last we were ₹2,300 crore, last year we did ₹4,800 crore. I think we will cross ₹30,000 crore in 2029 itself and not in 2030,” Tata Power Managing Director and CEO Praveer Sinha said during the company’s investor call on Tuesday. The revenue target advances the company’s earlier aspiration to achieve the ₹30,000 crore milestone by 2030 while serving 30 lakh households, reflecting management’s growing confidence in the pace of rooftop solar adoption as government incentives, falling battery costs, and rising consumer awareness drive demand. The company is also targeting a significant expansion in its leadership position in the rooftop solar



BOOMING BUSINESS. Tata Power ended the June quarter with cumulative rooftop solar installations of 5.2 GWp, serving more than 4.8 lakh customers **BTI**

segment. “I will also be increasing my market share from 13 per cent to 25 per cent. So I will be one of the biggest in the market and by a huge margin. In fact, the number two player in the market is just 2 per cent,” Sinha said. According to the company, the monthly rooftop installations have increased sharply over the past two years. “Two years back, I used to do 1,000 units a month; now, I do 30,000 units a month. This will be a gamechanger not only for us but for the country in terms of how power will be produced,” he said. **INTEGRATED SYSTEM** Sinha said the rooftop solar opportunity remains largely untapped. “India has 25

crore consumers, so the market potential is humongous. This is a product which is going to the poorest of the poor who take 1-kW systems and to others who take 2-20 kW,” he said. The company is increasingly bundling battery storage with rooftop solar systems, which it believes will further accelerate adoption. “Now we are giving them batteries also and so it makes them self-sufficient. The cost has come down and so it is making economic sense. It is good for the environment,” Sinha said. The company installed 371 MWp of rooftop solar capacity during the April-June quarter of FY27, up 37 per cent year-on-year, helping drive the performance of its renewable business.

Its solar manufacturing arm produced a record 1,001 MW of modules during the quarter at a manufacturing yield of 96.3 per cent, although renewable generation was partly impacted by curtailment in Rajasthan and Gujarat.

BIG CAPITAL Tata Power has retained its position as India’s largest rooftop solar player for 11 consecutive years. It ended the June quarter with cumulative rooftop solar installations of 5.2 GWp, serving more than 4.8 lakh customers through a nationwide network of 3,778 authorised channel partners and retailers. During FY26, the company installed around 2 GW of rooftop solar capacity, taking cumulative installations beyond 4.8 GWp. It installed more than 2.2 lakh rooftop systems during the year. The company has also launched MySine battery storage solutions to complement rooftop solar installations. Capital expenditure in the September quarter is expected to exceed ₹6,000 crore. Tata Power is also in plans to commission 800-900 MW of capacity during the quarter.

N Chandrasekaran optimistic on Tata Electronics despite steep loss

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Flagging chips as the new steel, Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran hailed Tata Electronics’ role in India’s technology sovereignty despite the steep loss reported in the larger company’s annual report.

Tata Electronics loss after tax widened over 20 times in the Tata Sons annual report, going from a loss of ₹70 crore in FY25 to ₹1,611 crore in FY26. In his remarks, Chandrasekaran instead focused on the gross or operating profits of the company before tax, stating that Tata Electronics has “already achieved break-even.” “Tata Electronics is on track to become the first integrated player across the electronics value chain. In four years, it has become the fourth-largest Tata Group company by revenue of ₹1,31,082 crore and nearly two-thirds of its workforce of 86,466 consists of women,” he said. **REVENUE SURGE** The top three high-revenue companies in the group are Tata Motors, Tata Consultancy Services and Tata Steel. In terms of revenue, the company grew 97 per



In four years, Tata Electronics has become the fourth-largest Tata Group company by revenue of ₹1,31,082 crore

N CHANDRASEKARAN
Tata Sons Chairman



cent on an annual basis. Further, it manufactured 12 per cent of the total volume of phones made by the global leader in 2025. The holding company also invested an additional ₹3,000 crore in Tata Electronics between FY25 and FY26, bringing the total investment to ₹9,961 crore.

HIGH-VOLUME FAB Tata’s manufacturing company is currently constructing India’s first high-volume fab in Gujarat, and packaged India’s first indigenous microprocessor. Further plans involve developing advanced packaging, indigenous electronics and semiconductor solutions, capabilities in semiconductor materials, and working with advanced lithography tools in Dholera. “Every phone, car, aircraft, hospital, power grid, and AI system runs on

[chips]. A nation that cannot make its own semiconductors will always depend on others for the most fundamental input of the modern economy,” said the Chairman in the report. He stressed the need for patient capital, global partnerships, thousands of highly-trained engineers, and years of disciplined execution since such execution “are among the most complex manufacturing endeavours humanity has attempted”. **CHIPS MANUFACTURING** The creation of chip-manufacturing plants would create an ecosystem of suppliers, talent pipelines and research linkages. “When the first “Made in India” chips flow at scale, they will do exactly what is needed for India’s technology sovereignty,” said Chandrasekaran.

Centre plans performance-based safety norms for 2Ws

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

The Centre plans to introduce performance-based safety norms for two-wheelers by replacing technology-specific regulatory mandates with functional safety standards in a move aimed at providing manufacturers greater engineering flexibility while strengthening road safety, sources told *businessline*. Accordingly, sources said that the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways

(MoRTH) is reworking the proposed regulatory framework to prescribe measurable safety outcomes, including braking performance and stopping distance, instead of mandating specific technologies such as anti-lock braking systems (ABS) or combined braking systems (CBS).

MANDATORY FITMENT The proposed changes follow representations from industry stakeholders over an earlier draft notification that prescribed the mandatory fitment of ABS and CBS across specified vehicle categories. At that time, manufacturers had argued that technology-specific regulations could restrict innovation and impose unnecessary engineering and manufac-



turing constraints across different vehicle platforms. Under the revised framework, manufacturers will instead be required to meet prescribed safety performance benchmarks while retaining the flexibility to deploy any technology capable of delivering the required braking outcomes. **SAFETY NORM** According to sources, the objective is to improve braking performance and reduce accidents arising from sudden braking and vehicle instability, particularly among

entry-level motorcycles and scooters, which account for a significant share of road fatalities in the country. Besides, the revised approach is expected to align India’s vehicle safety regulations more closely with evolving international regulatory practices, where performance-based standards are increasingly preferred over technology-specific mandates. Speaking to *businessline*, industry executives said the proposed framework is expected to strike a balance between improving road safety and allowing

manufacturers greater engineering flexibility while reducing compliance complexities for products developed for both domestic and export markets. The development comes as the Centre sharpens its focus on reducing road fatalities through improved vehicle safety regulations, better road engineering and stricter enforcement measures. Sources said MoRTH is expected to issue the revised draft notification shortly for stakeholder consultations before finalising the new norms.

are setting up a greenfield manufacturing unit near Ahmedabad, in a town called Mehsana, with a capex of around ₹1,000 crore. We expect this unit to be operational by January 2027,” HyFun Foods Managing Director and Group CEO Hareesh Karamchandani said. The company has plans to set up another greenfield unit in Madhya Pradesh with a capex of about 500 crore. Currently, the company has five manufacturing units in Gujarat.

HyFun unveils ₹1,500 cr investment for expansion

Press Trust of India
Mumbai

Frozen potato products manufacturers and exporters HyFun Foods is planning to invest ₹1,500 crore to set up units in Gujarat and Madhya Pradesh to support its expanding exports and domestic market presence, a senior company executive has said. “We are in the process of adding capacity and ensuring raw potato availability. We

Bottled soft drinks penetration rises to 44% in March-May

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Bottled soft drinks segment has achieved its highest in-home penetration in the March-May period this year with rural consumption outpacing urban in line with the broader FMCG trends. As per data sourced from Worldpanel by Numerator, the bottled soft drinks category, which includes carbonated drinks, mango-based drinks and juices, saw its in-home penetration grow to 44.1 per cent. K Ramakrishnan, MD, South Asia, Worldpanel by Numerator, told *businessline* that the category has seen significant evolution in the post-pandemic era. “Bottled soft drinks cat-

The rise in volume growth came despite unseasonal rain and delayed onset of the summer season

egory registered a penetration of 44.1 per cent in the March to May 2026 period. This is the highest in-home penetration that the category has ever achieved. In the corresponding period in 2025, the penetration stood at 42 per cent. This growth has led to a 9.3 per cent volume growth continuing the expansion of the category.” The rise in volume growth came even as unseasonal rains and delayed onset of

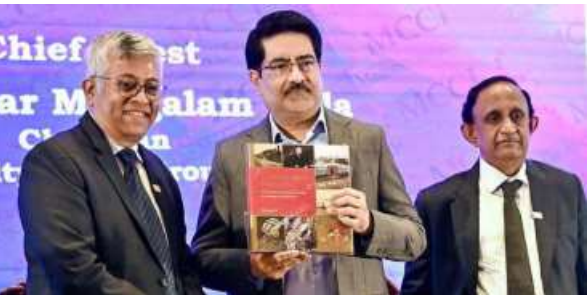
summer season was seen in various parts of the country. The data are based on the household panel data which measures the purchase of in-home FMCG categories. “In the March-May period of 2022, the gap between urban penetration and rural penetration was 9.4 per cent. In the 2026 period, this gap was just 1.6 per cent indicating the progress the category has seen in the rural market in just the last four years,” Ramakrishnan added. On Tuesday, Varun Beverages, the leading bottler of PepsiCo, said that in India it saw “healthy volume growth in twenties since the onset of season from March onwards except for the month of April resulting in overall volume growth for the June quarter of 14.4 per cent”.

‘Purpose, long-term bets build enduring businesses’

Our Bureau
Chennai

Long-term bets, and not quarterly performance reviews, build enduring businesses, industry titan Kumar Mangalam Birla, Chairman, Aditya Birla Group, said here on Tuesday. “The best businesses are built by looking beyond the next quarter to the next decade. That often means making transformational bets that may be unpopular in the short term, but create sustained value over a period of time,” Birla said in his address at the 190th annual general meeting of the Madras Chamber of Commerce and Industry (MCCI) in Chennai. Birla recounted the 2007 acquisition of Novelis by Hindalco, describing it as an unpopular decision that ulti-

mately transformed the company into a global value-added aluminium leader. “Long-term thinking demands conviction,” he said. On questions on how the behemoth group tackles macroeconomic fluctuations, Birla noted that they have remained fairly protected despite their global presence. **EXTRA COSTS** “In most cases, we have been able to pass on the extra costs, largely the fuel price increase, to customers,” he said, adding that long-term relationships with suppliers have also been leveraged and have helped them. With regard to India’s manufacturing prowess failing to fire up to its full potential, Birla noted that India has the potential, the credentials and track record to become a global manufactur-



LASTING LEGACY. Kumar Mangalam Birla, Chairman, Aditya Birla Group, with MCCI President Ramkumar Shankar (left) and A Viswanathan in Chennai on Tuesday **BJOY GHOSH**

ing powerhouse, and he was as unclear as others on why the manufacturing has fallen short. “It is important that we as an industry invest in manufacturing, and I believe the stars are now aligned,” the industrialist said. Birla also noted a need to engage with ‘GenZ’ workforce cohort differently. “Earlier, we used to think of culture as one single binding

young forever, to draw confidence from its roots but never be constrained by them,” he said, congratulating MCCI for a legacy as long as two centuries. He argued that scale is not just about achieving better cost structures, but changes industry economics by attracting suppliers, technology partners and capital. He cited UltraTech Cement’s journey as evidence of the power of scale. “Today, we have over 200 million tonnes of capacity, and UltraTech is the largest cement company in the world, other than in China,” he said. MCCI also appointed A Viswanathan, President, Delhi TVS Technologies Ltd, and Murali Vaidyanathan, President, Wheels India Ltd, as the new President and Vice-President of the Chamber respectively in Tuesday’s AGM.

Rooftop solar won’t cannibalise utility renewables, says Adani Green

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

India’s largest renewable power producer Adani Green Energy said it does not see the surge in rooftop solar installations under the Centre’s flagship residential solar programme cannibalising demand for largescale renewable projects, countering a concern that has increasingly surfaced among investors as distributed solar capacity accelerates. “We don’t foresee that distributed generation or rooftop is going to disrupt the overall energy requirement in this country,” Adani Green Chief Executive Ashish Khanna said. He said India’s rapid rooftop solar expansion is unlikely to dent the growth

prospects of utility-scale renewable energy projects, with rising electricity demand, evening peak consumption and growing industrial power requirements expected to create enough room for both segments to expand **PEAK DEMAND** Adani Green believes the opposite is likely to happen. “It is a very good sign in the way people are embracing clean energy. We don’t foresee any major challenge to the utility segment,” Khanna said. The firm argued that rooftop solar primarily addresses daytime consumption for households and commercial establishments but is not designed to meet evening peak demand or the large, round-the-clock electricity requirements of in-

dustries, data centres and urban infrastructure which can be met by utility-scale renewable energy projects backed by battery storage and pumped hydro systems capable of supplying firm power beyond daylight hours. “While solar energy has a certain role to play during the daytime — you have evening peaks and night and early morning requirements too — a rooftop at someone’s house or C&I segment will not be able to sustain,” he added **RAPID ADOPTION** Industry executives have increasingly debated whether rapid rooftop adoption could reduce the need for new utility-scale solar parks and future power purchase agreements by distribution



companies. As of June 2026, India had about 30 GW of installed rooftop solar capacity, accounting for nearly 18.5 per cent of the country’s total installed solar capacity of 162 GW. This marks a steady increase in rooftop solar’s share of the national solar fleet from about 14.5 per cent in 2023-24 to around 16 per cent in 2024-25, underscoring the rapid expansion of distributed solar installa-

tions under the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana and other rooftop programmes. **ENERGY STORAGE** Adani Green is also focusing on energy storage. The company commissioned 1.9 GWh of battery energy storage capacity in the June quarter, taking its operational battery portfolio to 3.5 GWh, and reiterated its target of crossing 10 GWh by FY27 end and scaling up to 50 GWh by 2030. The company is also preparing to commission its maiden 500 MW pumped storage project at Chitravathi in Andhra Pradesh during the current financial year, further strengthening its portfolio of dispatchable renewable assets. Adani Green’s assessment

comes amid a broader shift in India’s electricity landscape. While rooftop solar is reducing dependence on grid power for many consumers, overall electricity demand continues to rise on the back of economic growth, increasing electrification, air-conditioning demand and the emergence of power-intensive sectors such as data centres, electric mobility and green hydrogen. **CLEAN POWER** For utility-scale developers, the challenge is therefore evolving from simply adding renewable capacity to supplying reliable, round-the-clock clean power — an opportunity the company believes will support continued investments in large renewable parks alongside distributed solar.

TruAlt Bioenergy Q1 net zooms to ₹59.27 crore

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

TruAlt Bioenergy Limited, India’s largest ethanol producer by installed capacity, has reported over a 12-fold growth in its profit after tax for the June quarter on higher revenues. The company reported a PAT of ₹59.27 crore for Q1FY27 over same period last year’s ₹4.73 crore. Revenues for the quarter were up 96 per cent at ₹641.41 crore against corresponding last quarter’s ₹326.63 crore. The performance reflects the successful integration of the company’s dual-feed ethanol platform and the continued execution of its integ-

rated bioenergy strategy, TruAlt said. TruAlt’s installed ethanol capacity increased by 43 per cent from 1,400 KLPD in Q1 FY26 to 2,000 KLPD in Q1 FY27, with approximately 1,300 KLPD (65 per cent) now operating on dual-feed technology. TruAlt currently operates seven retail fuel outlets, with further expansion planned under its phased strategy to establish a network of 100 outlets. “This transformation has given us the flexibility to produce ethanol from both sugar-based feedstocks and grains, enabling near year-round operations while creating a profitable business,” said Vijay Nirani, MD, TruAlt Bioenergy.

QUICKLY.

Cognizant bags Novartis IT operations deal

Chennai: US and Chennai-based information technology (IT) service major Cognizant has announced it has been selected by global pharmaceuticals giant Novartis for a five-year, artificial intelligence-enabled integrated IT operations deal. Under the agreement, Cognizant will help consolidate applications, infrastructure, security, digital workplace and platform services into a unified, end-to-end operating model powered by AI, automation and agentic capabilities. OUR BUREAU

Infosys powers NTN with SAP Commerce Cloud

Bengaluru: Infosys has announced the successful migration of NTN Corporation's on-premises SAP Commerce-based e-commerce platform, e-WINGS, to SAP Commerce Cloud 2211. NTN Corporation is among the world's leading manufacturers of precision equipment, including bearings. The transformation delivered tangible benefits for NTN Corporation, including streamlined maintenance by automating version control, enhanced reliability in daily operations, and improving cost efficiencies by enabling cloud adoption. With scalable, cloud-based architecture now in place, NTN is well-positioned to pursue digital growth with greater agility, modernise legacy system management, and focus on innovation. OUR BUREAU

Meta sorry for PM Modi's Facebook video glitch

ON WATCH. If system caused error, then the firm must improve its tools: Govt officials

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Tech giant Meta on Tuesday apologised to the government after a video featuring Prime Minister Narendra Modi was briefly taken down from Facebook in India due to what it called a “technical glitch”.

“The content was removed in error and has since been restored,” a Meta spokesperson said.

Sources in the government said the Centre is treating the incident seriously and is examining both Meta's explanation and the circumstances that led to the video's removal.

They also said Meta's explanation was not reasonable, and deeper discussions were needed, adding that the matter is “not settled and done”.

The government officials said that if a glitch in the automated system caused the error, then Meta must improve its tools.

The Global Head of Public Policy of Meta has also been summoned by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) over the issue.

The PM's Instagram post on July 23, later shared on Facebook, had featured his first direct selfie video aimed



TECH GLITCH. A video featuring PM Narendra Modi was briefly taken down from Facebook due to an error. REUTERS

at engaging with young people and underscoring the government's commitment to crack down on paper leaks, but was subsequently restricted by Meta on Facebook, prompting BJP worker Priti Gandhi to question the platform's actions, and leading MeitY to summon the company's representatives.

PRIVACY PROTECTION Meanwhile, the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Information Technology and Communications has also summoned representatives of major social media platforms, including Meta (Facebook, Instagram and WhatsApp), Snapchat, X (Twitter)

The Centre is treating the incident seriously and is examining Meta's explanation, said government sources

and Google on August 3 to discuss other issues.

BJP Member of Parliament Nishikant Dubey, who chairs the Committee, said the panel has called representatives of these companies to explain how they protect the privacy of women, children, farmers, rural residents, labourers and the general pub-

lic, and ensure public order.

“Our Parliamentary Committee on IT and Communication has summoned Meta (Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp), X (Twitter), Snapchat, and Google. How will the privacy of women, children, farmers, rural folks, labourers, and the general public be protected? How do these companies ensure the government's public order?,” Dubey said via a post on X. According to the notice issued, the agenda includes a “briefing by the representatives of (i) Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY); (ii) Ministry of Home Affairs; and (iii) Social and Digital Media Platforms — Snapchat, Google, X (formerly Twitter), Meta (Facebook and Instagram) on the subject ‘Social and digital platforms and their regulation’.” The meeting comes days after social media, particularly Instagram, was extensively used by the Cockroach Janta Party to publicise and mobilise participants for its student protest at Jantar Mantar.

The demonstrations, which were held over the NEET-UG paper leak and other issues, drew widespread attention online, with videos, reels and live updates from the protest sites being shared across social media platforms.

Voda-Idea adds 1,63,757 subscribers in June as telecom competition intensifies

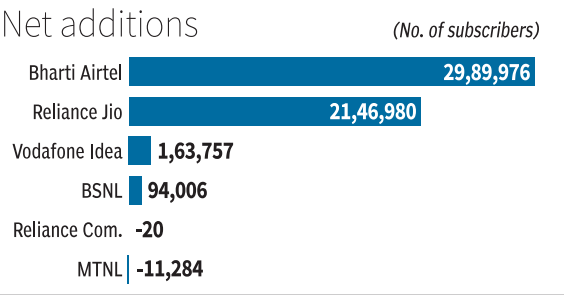
S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Telecom operator Vodafone Idea (VI) has recorded fifth consecutive month of adding mobile subscribers with 1,63,757 net addition in June, the latest data shared by Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) said on Tuesday.

Market leader Reliance Jio recorded a net addition of 21,46,980 subscribers, while Bharti Airtel added the most customers during the month with a net addition of 29,89,976 subscribers. State-owned Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited reported a net addition of 94,006 subscribers in June, the TRAI monthly telecom subscription data indicated.

According to analysts, the consistent growth in subscribers for VI can be attributed to the Supreme Court relief on the adjusted gross revenue, subsequently followed by government measures in line with the judgment. This helped the operator to focus on looking ahead than remain entangled in improving financial health. “That would have been a major relief I am sure for the entire management of VI to think of customers than financial statements.

The VI management acted swift to take benefit of this relief as well as the network expansion which they worked on. Along with it they started offering industry plans where customers could get premium content... So VI took the complete advantage



Source: TRAI

of the relief and augmented its network as well as services to be able to service customers well. Its sustained subscriber growth is a reflection of this effort,” Faisal Ka-woosa, Chief Analyst and Founder at Techarc, said.

The continued subscriber momentum also reflects the positive customer response to VI's ongoing network expansion and service enhancements. VI has significantly accelerated its 5G rollout, with 5G now available across more than 200 cities nationwide, while continuing to expand its footprint to newer locations.

Over the last six months, the company has added a cumulative 4,63,129 net subscribers, reflecting sustained improvement in customer acquisition. The company's total subscriber base now stands at 19,88,23,098.

MONTHLY REPORT Meanwhile, the TRAI monthly report said that the total number of wireless (mobile) subscribers increased from 1,277 million at the end of May 2026 to 1,282.38 million at the end of June, thereby registering a

monthly growth rate of 0.42 per cent.

Out of the total 1,282.38 million mobile subscribers, 1,201.06 million mobile subscribers were active on the date of peak in the month of June 2026, it said adding that in June, about 14.78 million subscribers submitted their requests for mobile number portability. “Wireless subscription in urban areas increased from 734.63 million at the end of May 2026 to 739.43 million at the end of June 2026 and wireless subscription in rural areas also increased from 542.36 million to 542.95 million during the same period. The monthly growth rates of urban and rural wireless subscription were 0.65 per cent and 0.11 per cent respectively,” TRAI said.

TRAI said the mobile tele-density in India increased to 89.71 per cent at the end of June from 89.39 per cent at the end of May. The share of urban and rural mobile subscribers in the total number of wireless mobile subscribers were 57.66 per cent and 42.34 per cent respectively, at the end of June 2026, the regulator said.

Nuvoco sees Gujarat business matching North India profitability in 2-3 years

Avinash Naik
Ahmedabad



Jayakumar Krishnaswamy, Managing Director

The cement arm of Nirma Group — Nuvoco Vistas Corp — expects its business in Gujarat to achieve profitability levels comparable to its North India operations within two to three years, as the company ramps up capacity in the western market while maintaining its premium positioning.

“I don't think we can judge the performance by the first year of launch in Gujarat. Our modelling very clearly says that in the second and third year, EBITDA per tonne in Gujarat will be equal to EBITDA per tonne of the rest of North India,” Managing Director Jayakumar Krishnaswamy said during the company's post-earnings analyst call recently.

The comments come after Nuvoco inaugurated its 2 million tonne per annum

(MTPA) Surat grinding unit earlier this month, marking its first capacity expansion in western India.

CAPACITY RAMP-UP

The company is also commissioning the Vadraj assets in phases, with the Kutch clinker unit expected to become operational later this financial year.

Krishnaswamy said the company is targeting annualised cement sales of around 2 million tonnes in Gujarat by the fourth quarter of FY27,

up from the current run rate of 1.3-1.4 million tonnes.

Initially, clinker for the Surat unit will be sourced from Nuvoco's Chhattisgarh cluster until the Kutch clinker plant starts operations. The company is also evaluating clinker swaps with other cement makers to reduce logistics costs.

PREMIUM POSITIONING Despite expanding aggressively in Gujarat, Nuvoco said it does not intend to sacrifice pricing to gain market share. “We will play aggressively to sell our product. But one thing is for sure, our positioning as an A-group player will never reduce,” Krishnaswamy said.

He said Nuvoco has already established a presence in Gujarat over the past two years and has expanded its dealer network across markets, including Rajkot, Saurashtra, and Porbandar, ahead of the new capacity

coming on stream.

Nuvoco maintained its demand outlook for the current financial year, expecting cement demand to grow 7-8 per cent, supported by government-led infrastructure spending and housing activity.



CHOLAMANDALAM INVESTMENT AND FINANCE COMPANY LIMITED
CIN: L65993TN1978PLC007576
Registered Office : “Chola Crest,” C54 - C55, Super B-4, Thiru-Vi-Ka Industrial Estate, Guindy, Chennai-600032.
Phone number: 044-040907172; Email: investors@chola.murugappa.com; Website: www.cholamandalam.com



EXTRACT OF THE DETAILED FORMAT OF STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED UN-AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026

Sl. No	Particulars	Standalone			
		Quarter ended		Year ended	
		30.06.2026 Un-Audited	31.03.2026 Audited	30.06.2025 Un-Audited	31.03.2026 Audited
1.	Total income from operations	8,932.95	8,538.57	7,330.78	31,444.84
2.	Net Profit for the period before Tax	2,220.49	2,137.37	1,529.64	6,960.66
3.	Net Profit for the period after Tax	1,653.59	1,640.71	1,135.91	5,219.59
4.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (Comprising Profit for the period after tax and Other Comprehensive Income after tax)	1,628.31	1,808.11	1,056.11	5,392.06
5.	Equity Share Capital	170.59	170.48	168.30	170.48
6.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserves, securities premium account and capital redemption reserve)	25,420.47	23,785.08	19,536.40	23,785.08
7.	Securities premium account	6,454.33	6,415.46	4,977.26	6,415.46
8.	Capital Redemption reserve	33.00	33.00	33.00	33.00
9.	Networth	32,078.39	30,404.02	24,714.96	30,404.02
10.	Outstanding Debt	2,20,247.07	2,10,866.56	1,81,304.07	2,10,866.56
11.	Outstanding Redeemable preference shares	Nil	Nil	Nil	Nil
12.	Debtenture Redemption reserve	Not applicable	Not applicable	Not applicable	Not applicable
13.	Debt Equity Ratio	6.87	6.94	7.34	6.94
14.	Earnings Per Share (EPS) - (₹2/- per share) (not annualised for interim period)	19.40	19.28	13.51	61.83
	a) Basic				
	b) Diluted	19.36	19.23	13.47	61.68

Note: Interest Service Coverage Ratio and Debt Service Coverage ratio are not applicable as the company is a NBFC.

Sl. No	Particulars	Consolidated			
		Quarter ended		Year ended	
		30.06.2026 Un-Audited	31.03.2026 Audited	30.06.2025 Un-Audited	31.03.2026 Audited
1.	Total income from operations	8,956.68	8,563.54	7,353.09	31,538.73
2.	Net Profit for the period before Tax	2,223.56	2,143.12	1,532.00	6,976.77
3.	Net Profit for the period after Tax	1,656.22	1,645.20	1,137.83	5,232.61
4.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (Comprising Profit for the period after tax and Other Comprehensive Income after tax)	1,630.94	1,812.64	1,058.03	5,405.11
5.	Equity Share Capital	170.59	170.48	168.30	170.48
6.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserves, securities premium account and capital redemption reserve)	25,477.49	23,839.46	19,579.63	23,839.46
7.	Securities premium account	6,454.33	6,415.46	4,977.26	6,415.46
8.	Capital Redemption reserve	33.00	33.00	33.00	33.00
9.	Networth	32,135.41	30,458.40	24,758.19	30,458.40
10.	Outstanding Debt	2,20,501.24	2,11,069.61	1,81,404.02	2,11,069.61
11.	Outstanding Redeemable preference shares	Nil	Nil	Nil	Nil
12.	Debtenture Redemption reserve	Not applicable	Not applicable	Not applicable	Not applicable
13.	Debt Equity Ratio	6.86	6.93	7.33	6.93
14.	Earnings Per Share (EPS) - (₹2/- per share) (not annualised for interim period)	19.43	19.33	13.53	61.98
	a) Basic				
	b) Diluted	19.40	19.28	13.50	61.83

Note: The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results for the Quarter ended June 30, 2026 is available on the Stock Exchange websites, www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com and also on the Company's website www.cholamandalam.com. The financial results can be accessed by scanning the QR code provided below:



On behalf of the Board of Directors

Ravindra Kumar Kundu
Managing Director
DIN: 07337155

Place : Chennai
Date : July 28, 2026

visit us at
www.cholamandalam.com

Tata firms offer AI-driven virtual assistants for small businesses

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Tata Communications and Tata Tele Business Services (TTBS) are offering virtual assistants with dedicated fixed-line phone numbers to small and medium businesses (SMBs) through a unified AI stack announced on Tuesday.

The collaboration combines Tata Communications Voice AI solutions with TTBS' robust go-to-market scale to offer customer experience offerings to SMBs. This includes leveraging TTBS' licence to provide phone numbers to every AI agent, thus offering an identity to each agent.

DIGITAL WORKERS

“SMBs normally do not have a contact centre. So, we would want the SMBs to think of this as hiring digital workers across the globe. It is just like digital workers who have their own identity. Where I hire five people, tomorrow I hire 5,000 AI agents,” Ganesh Lakshminarayanan, MD & CEO, Tata

Communications, told *businessline*.

While both Lakshminarayanan as well as Harjit Singh, Managing Director, TTBS, said the small businesses will not need to worry about tokenisation costs, the offering will be based on a subscription model depending on the usage of the product.

WHOLE INFRA

“Managing input costs like tokens, the whole infrastructure that you saw is managed by us,” said the CEO. In line with Tata Communications' digital transformation plans, the company's Chief Transformation Officer will also be actively involved in the operation of the new AI stack products.

The AI-powered voice agents will manage customer interactions, handle routine enquiries, schedule appointments and follow-ups, process orders and provide personalised and always-on support at scale.

The solution is powered by Commotion, Tata Communications' conversational AI platform, and hosted on

Tata Communications' Vayu AI Cloud, providing scalable and robust AI capabilities.

The underlying voice infrastructure, ensuring high-quality, secure connectivity is powered by TTBS.

These AI agents securely access the data they require through a unified network fabric, integrating the respective capabilities of the companies.

The CEO flagged a 30 per cent lead conversion increase and 20 per cent increase in per store conversion, while demonstrating specific use cases during the launch.

“This is one offering which will appeal to many SMBs. Our hope is that we scale this proportionately. There are roughly 1,000 SMEs that we work with every month,” Singh told *businessline*.

When asked about spam concerns, Lakshminarayanan said, “We have been working with companies to make sure spam is removed. We work with the regulators to make sure the solution is fully compliant with all the local laws.”

KOVILPATTI LAKSHMI ROLLER FLOUR MILLS LIMITED
CIN: L15314TN1961PLC004674
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E-Mail: ho@klrf.in, Web: www.klrf.in.

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS

Dear Member(s),

- Notice is hereby given that the 64th Annual General Meeting (“AGM”) of the Company will be held on Wednesday, 9th September, 2026 at 09:15 AM (IST) through Video Conference (“VC”) / Other Audio-Visual Means (“OAVM”) facility without the physical presence of members at a common venue to transact the business(es) as set out in the Notice which will be circulated for convening the AGM, in compliance with the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and rules framed thereunder and the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 read with relevant circular(s) issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (“MCA Circular(s)”) and the Securities and Exchange Board of India (“SEBI Circulars”) from time to time.
- The Notice of the 64th AGM and the Annual Report for the year ended 31st March 2026 including the Audited Financial Statements for the year ended 31st March 2026 (“Annual Report”) is being sent only by e-mail to all those members, whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Company/RTA or with their respective Depository Participant (“DP”) in accordance with the MCA Circular(s) and the SEBI Circular(s) as mentioned above. For Members who have not registered their email address, a letter containing the exact weblink of the website wherein the entire Annual Report will be hosted and the path to access the same, will be sent to the address of the shareholders as registered in the records of the Company / RTA / DP.
- Members can join and participate in the 64th AGM through VC/OAVM facility only. The instructions for joining the 64th AGM and the manner of participation in the remote e-voting or casting vote through the e-voting system during the 64th AGM will be provided in the Notice of the 64th AGM. Members participating through the VC/OAVM facility shall be counted for the purpose of reckoning the quorum under Section 103 of the Companies Act, 2013.
- Notice of the 64th AGM and the Annual Report for FY 2025-26 will be made available on the website of the Company i.e., www.klrf.in and on the website of Stock Exchange in which the Company's equity shares are listed i.e., BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com) and on the website of e-voting service provider i.e. MUFG Intime India Private Limited (Formerly known as “Link Intime India Private Limited”) (https://intavote.linkintime.co.in/).
- Members, who wish to register their email address / bank account mandate for receiving dividends (if any) directly through Electronic Clearing Service (ECS) may follow the below instructions:
 - Members holding shares in demat form are requested to register / update the said details in their demat account, as per the process advised by the concerned Depository Participant.
 - Members holding shares in physical form are requested to register / update the said details by filing the prescribed Form ISR-1 and other relevant forms with the Registrar & Share Transfer Agent (RTA) of the Company viz., MUFG Intime India Private Limited (Formerly known as “Link Intime India Private Limited”) by sending email at investorhelpdesk@in.mfms.mufg.com. Members may download the prescribed forms from the company's website https://www.klrf.in/investorcentre. In this regard, it is to be noted that SEBI vide its Master Circular No. HO/38/13(4)/2026-MRSD-POD/4298/2026 dated 6th February, 2026 had mandated that with effect from 1st April 2024, dividend (if any) to shareholders who are holding shares in physical form shall be paid only through electronic mode. Hence such payment (if any) shall be made only after the shareholders furnish their PAN, choice of nomination, contact details (postal address with PIN and mobile number), Bank Account details and specimen signature.
- Members holding shares in physical form or who have not registered their email address with the Company / RTA may cast their vote on the business item(s) set forth in the Notice of the 64th AGM through remote e-voting or through e-voting platform provided during the 64th AGM. The manner of voting through remote e-voting or through e-voting during the AGM will be provided in the Notice of 64th AGM.
- Members may note that dividend is taxable in the hands of the shareholders and the Company is required to deduct tax at source (“TDS”) from dividend paid to the Members at the prescribed rates in the Income Tax Act, 2025. For the prescribed rates for various categories, the Shareholders are requested to refer to the Income Tax Act, 2025, its rules and amendments thereof. Shareholders are therefore immediately requested to furnish the necessary documents / declarations to the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (RTA), MUFG Intime India Private Limited (formerly “Link Intime India Private Limited”) to enable the Company in applying appropriate TDS percentage on dividend payment.
- Considering the above, we request the shareholders to update their e-mail ID, Bank account details & Permanent Account Number (PAN) Depository Participant (if held in demat form). In case the shares are held in physical form, the shareholders are requested to update their email ID, bank account details, contact details, specimen signature and PAN with the Company / RTA. This will ensure receipt of the Annual Report, dividend and/or any other communications from the Company.

The above information is being issued for the information and benefit of all the Members of the Company and is in accordance with the MCA Circular/s and the SEBI Circulars.

By Order of the Board
For Kovilpatti Lakshmi Roller Flour Mills Limited
S/-

S.Piramuthu
Company Secretary
Membership No. FCS 9142

Place : Gangaikondan
Date : 28.07.2026





A CH-CE

QUICKLY.

Gold falls as \$ hovers near 1-month peak



Gold fell on Tuesday, weighed down by a strong dollar that hovered near a one-month high, while investors awaited this week's US Federal Reserve interest rate decision. Spot gold fell 1.1 per cent to \$4,032.42 per ounce by 1327 GMT. US gold futures for August delivery slid 1.1 per cent to \$4,032.40. REUTERS

Metals dip as traders await Fed rate decision

Copper declined, weighed down by a strong dollar and rising bets on an interest rate hike by the Federal Reserve that could dampen demand for industrial metals. Benchmark three month copper on the LME was down 0.9 per cent at \$13,605 a tonne. Aluminium lost 0.8 per cent to \$3,143. Zinc shed 1 per cent to \$3,575. Tin lost 1.4 per cent to \$53,600. REUTERS

Crude oil extends loss as US and Iran pause attacks



Crude oil prices were down by over \$1 per barrel amid hopes for a resolution in the US-Iran war which significantly disrupted global energy flows. Brent crude futures were down \$1.47 at \$86.89 by 0326 GMT, while US WTI crude was at \$81.16 a barrel, down \$1.45. Both contracts slid around eight per cent in the prior session. REUTERS

Maize shortfall may force ethanol makers to rely on rice

FILLING THE GAP. Top five maize-producing States report a 13% drop in acreage; low sugar stocks may make rice the key feedstock

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

A sharp drop in kharif maize (corn) acreage in top producing States is likely to push India's ethanol blending programme to rely more on sugarcane and rice in the 2026-27 supply year. The area under maize in the top five producing States has declined by over 13 per cent, led by a 34 per cent plunge in Karnataka, raising concerns over grain availability for ethanol production. With sugar stocks expected to be tight by the end of the current sugar season on September 30, the government may ultimately have to depend more on rice to meet ethanol demand. This could lend support to rice prices, with demand already firming up for select

non-basmati varieties. India requires about 1,100 crore litres of ethanol annually to achieve the 20 per cent ethanol blending-with-petrol (EBP) target. Of the country's nearly 2,000 crore litres of installed ethanol capacity, around 900 crore litres is based on sugar feedstock, while the rest is grain-based. Sugarcane sowing has been completed, with the acreage at 57.58 lakh hectares (lh) against 58.84 lh last year. Among the three key producing States, Uttar Pradesh has increased cane area to 28.97 lh from 28.61 lh, Maharashtra to 11.82 lh from 11.47 lh, and Karnataka to 6.61 lh from 6.08 lh, according to government data. In contrast, maize acreage across the country was 9.7 per cent lower at 77.79 lh as



HIGHER AVAILABILITY. The government's recent decision to reduce the broken rice component in official stocks from 25 per cent to 10 per cent would make more broken rice available for industrial use, including ethanol production

of July 24, compared with 86.15 lh a year ago. The decline was particularly steep in Karnataka (-34 per cent), Uttar Pradesh (-37 per cent), Maharashtra (-16

per cent) and Rajasthan (-3 per cent). The only major exception is Madhya Pradesh, where maize acreage has risen 8.2 per cent to 25.61 lh from 23.67 lh.

PADDY SOWING MIXED Paddy sowing has shown a mixed trend. Among major growers, acreage has increased in Uttar Pradesh (57.8 lh, up 4.2 per cent),

Punjab (31.66 lh), Bihar (17.58 lh, up 36.4 per cent), Assam (11.68 lh, up 73 per cent) and Andhra Pradesh (4.74 lh, up 6 per cent). The shortfall in Chhattisgarh and Odisha — about 1-1.6 lakh hectares below last year's level — is expected to narrow following the ongoing spell of rain. However, paddy area remains significantly lower in Madhya Pradesh, down 29 per cent to 19.54 lh from 27.39 lh, and in Maharashtra at 4.9 lh against 8.59 lh last year. Summer declines have also been reported in West Bengal, Haryana, Telangana and Odisha.

DIVERSIFIED FEEDSTOCK CK Jain, President of the Grain Ethanol Manufacturers Association, said India's diversified ethanol ecosys-

tem, which draws feedstock from kharif, rabi and summer crops, reduces dependence on any single crop or season. He pointed to the government's recent decision to reduce the broken rice component in official stocks from 25 per cent to 10 per cent, saying that it would make more broken rice available for industrial use, including ethanol production, without compromising food security. "Fresh kharif crop arrivals are expected to further strengthen feedstock availability as the season progresses," Jain said. He said India remains a net surplus maize producer, providing confidence that domestic supplies will be adequate to support ethanol blending requirements despite the current acreage decline.

Cotton area expands as monsoon gathers pace, coverage tops 100 lh

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Cotton sowing has picked up pace with the monsoon gathering momentum across key producing States. The total acreage has crossed 100 lakh hectares (lh) with Telangana, Madhya Pradesh and Andhra Pradesh registering an increase in area compared to last year. The delayed onset and progress of the monsoon pushed back the sowing window by a couple of weeks this year. Stakeholders said the crop condition is good and expect the area to surpass last year's levels. Atul Ganatra, Chairman, Crop Committee at the apex



trade body Cotton Association of India (CAI), said sowing had been completed on over 100 lh against 103 lh a year ago.

EXTENDED WINDOW Ganatra said due to the delayed rain, the sowing window for cotton had now been extended till August 25. "We feel the government's target of over 120 lakh hectares of cotton sowing is very

much possible by August 20," he said. Sowing is taking place on about 50,000 hectares every day, Ganatra said, adding that in Andhra Pradesh, the area had increased by 31 per cent and by 4 per cent in Telangana. In Gujarat, with the recent rain, coupled with the ₹14,000 per acre subsidy announced by the State government, the cotton acreage is likely to increase by 7-10 per cent this year, he said. In Maharashtra, the cotton area was 35.76 lh (37.89 lh in the corresponding last year), while in Telangana it was up 4 per cent at 17.64 lh. Madhya Pradesh has also seen an increase in area to 5.79 lh (5.52 lh).

HEALTHY CROP Ramanuj Das Boob, a sourcing agent in Raichur said the sowing is complete in Telangana and the crop condition is good. Also, in Raichur, Karnataka and Adoni in Andhra Pradesh, the crop looks better with recent rain. "Overall, the crop condition looks satisfactory, but there's a need for further big showers to improve the growth of the plants." In the Khandesh region of Maharashtra, the crop condition looks good. "Though there is deficit rain, the crop condition looks healthy as of now. In the irrigated areas, the crop is good," said Pradeep Jain, Chairman, Khandesh Gin Press Association in Jalgaon.

Women power India's agriculture, constitute 60% of farm workforce

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

Women account for nearly 60 per cent of India's agricultural workforce in calendar year 2025, according to the government. In a written reply in the Lok Sabha on Tuesday, Union Minister of State for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare Ramnath Thakur said women constituted 59.8 per cent of the total workforce engaged in agriculture during January-December 2025. Citing the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) of the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation, he said 41.1 per cent of women employed in agriculture were self-employed dur-

ing the period.

PM-KISAN BENEFITS Referring to the PM-KISAN scheme, under which eligible farmers receive ₹6,000 annually through direct benefit transfer, Thakur said it had significantly benefited women farmers by providing transparent and direct financial support, strengthening both their incomes and participation in agriculture. A total of 2,18,66,774 women beneficiaries received the 23rd instalment under the scheme. On the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY), he said the crop insurance scheme provides comprehensive coverage against crop losses from pre-sowing to post-harvest for notified crops and areas. Women accounted for 21 per

cent of farmers enrolled under the scheme in 2024-25. **CROPPED AREA** Replying to a separate question on agricultural land, Thakur, citing the Land Use Statistics 2024-25, said the country's gross cropped area increased from 198.28 million hectares in 2014-15 to 225.19 million hectares in 2024-25. He attributed the increase to the adoption of modern technologies and effective policy interventions, which improved cropping intensity from 142.2 per cent to 159.7 per cent during the period. The higher cropping intensity reflects greater adoption of multiple cropping, enabling farmers to cultivate the same land more than once in a year.

US, China lead investors back to gold ETFs as inflows turned positive last week

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Physically backed gold exchange-traded funds witnessed net positive investments of \$2.62 billion last week as investors in the US and China led the return, data from the World Gold Council (WGC) showed. According to analysts and experts, with gold prices ruling around \$4,000 an ounce, there was renewed investment interest. WGC data showed that investments last week were \$3.36 billion, while exits were \$750 million. At \$1.55 billion, the US led the return to gold ETFs, followed by China at \$633 million. **CRUCIAL FLOOR** "The support of \$4,000 remains a crucial floor for the metal," said Colin Shah,

Founder and Managing Director of Kama Jewelry. "The long-term structural demand will continue to be resilient with mild jitters based on real-time economic developments," Shah said. Renisha Chainani, Head of Research at Augmont, said that with the US Fed's decision coming up next week and no sign that the West Asia tensions are cooling, gold and silver are likely to stay highly reactive to news developments. "A softer tone from the Fed or a fresh conflict in the Gulf could bring haven buying back," she said. Last week, investments in North America were \$1.57 billion, while they were \$622 million in Asia, followed by Europe at \$388.5 million. Country-wise, after the US and China, investors in the UK chipped in with \$171.5 million.

Gaining sparkle		
(in \$ billion)		
	Inflows/outflows(-)	
	as of July 17	as of July 24
North America	-8.72	-7.13
Europe	4.18	4.63
Asia	11.94	12.55
Others	0.22	0.25
Total global inflows	83.95	87.38
Total global outflows	76.33	77.08
*Year-to-date as of July 24 Source: WGC		

US INFLOWS NEGATIVE Year-to-date, net investments in North America are negative, with investors exiting to the tune of \$7.14 billion. But outflows from the US were higher at \$7.52 billion. Asia is holding ETFs on the positive side with total investments at \$12.55 billion. China leads the trend

with \$6.03 billion inflows, though they are down from over \$9.5 billion in March. At \$3.86 billion, Indian inflows are the second biggest. Japan (\$693 million), the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region (\$948 million) and Singapore (\$316 million), too, contributed to the net positive inflows in ETFs. Investments in Europe are also positive at \$4.63 billion, led by the UK at \$2.66 billion. Switzerland inflows are a significant \$2.21 billion. However, investors in France (-\$254.5 million) and Italy (-\$209 million) lead the outflows. Gold ETFs have been going through a roller coaster ride after the Iran war broke out on February 28. Fears of inflation, rise in bond yields, hike in US Fed rates and consumers shifting to crude oil counters have all weighed on the yellow metal.

Govt asks sugar dealers to hold maximum 400 t stock till Nov

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

The Union government has issued an order fixing a maximum stock limit of 400 tonnes of sugar that any dealer can keep at any point of time till November 30. Traders have been mandated to liquidate excess stock by August 1 from when the directive will be implemented. Besides, dealers have been asked to sell the sweetener within 30 days from the date of receipt. In a gazette notification on July 28, the Ministry of Food and Consumer Affairs imposed the restriction using powers under section 3 of the Essential Commodities Act, 1955, and the Sugar (Control) Order, 2025. The Food Ministry also allowed the States to lower the stock limit below 400 tonnes, if required.

El Nino strengthens, eyes strongest levels since 1950: Australian Met body

Srikrishnan PC
Chennai

El Nino, which has been in place since mid-June, continues to strengthen, with further intensification likely in the coming months, according to the Southern Hemisphere monitoring report from the Bureau of Meteorology, Australia (BoM). The warming in the central tropical Pacific is indicative of a strong to very strong El Nino event. Most models indicate that this event is likely to reach levels among the highest observed since 1950 or above, the report said. **IOD OUTLOOK** The latest relative Nino3.4 index value for the week ending July 26 is +1.94°C, well above the El Nino threshold (+0.80°C) and warming by 0.5°C over the past fortnight. The current status of the Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD) is neutral. The weekly IOD index is +0.44°C as of July 26, warming by about 0.5°C over the last fortnight. This is the first week the index crossed the positive IOD threshold (+0.4°C), with sustained values above this threshold required before an event is considered established. Models suggest a positive IOD could form during the Southern Hemisphere winter and last into spring, though the timing and strength of the potential event still show some variation. **STRONG EVENT** Models predict that the tropical Pacific will continue warming through the Southern Hemisphere spring (November) and will probably reach a maximum in late spring or summer (February).

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ary). The strength of this El Nino, along with its usual life cycle, suggests that the current one could last through the autumn of 2027. Trade winds are reversed or weaker than normal across the western tropical Pacific, with cloudiness enhanced near the International Date Line and suppressed over the Maritime Continent, and the Southern Oscillation Index (SOI) remains strongly negative, with the latest 30-day SOI to July 26 at -28, the report said. Sea Surface Temperature (SST) analysis for the week ending July 26 indicates above-average waters over much of Australia and near-average to the north-east. More broadly, global SSTs have been well above average, with June 2026 global SSTs being 0.51 °C above the 1991-2020 average, making it the warmest June on record (since 1900).

VST Tillers Tractors to set up ₹100 cr global tech centre in Hosur

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Farm equipment maker VST Tillers Tractors Ltd (VTTL) conducted the groundbreaking ceremony for its Global Tech Centre in Hosur on Tuesday. Being established on an investment of ₹100 crore, the facility will significantly strengthen the company's research and development capabilities and serve as the primary global hub for advanced engineering and innovation, the company said in a statement. The Global Tech Centre has been envisioned to accelerate the development of next-generation technologies, with a strong focus on tractors, tillers, farm mechanisation equipment and intelligent farm machinery for

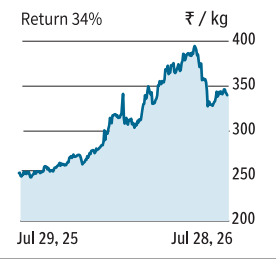
sustainable agricultural solutions using both ICE and EV drive trains. **NEXT GEN TECH** The facility will play a pivotal role in fast-tracking innovation, developing proprietary technologies, enhancing testing and validation capabilities, and fostering collaboration with global technology partners and research institutions. VT Ravindra, Managing Director, said, "As agriculture rapidly embraces electrification, automation and digital technologies, this facility will become the cornerstone of our future R&D initiatives. It will enable us to accelerate innovation, develop proprietary technologies and create world-class products that empower farmers with smarter, more

sustainable mechanisation solutions." **FARM MECHANISATION** The facility will significantly enhance VST's product development ecosystem by strengthening testing infrastructure, accelerate the development and address customer requirements across different continents. The investment underscores VST's long-term commitment to delivering innovative, efficient and sustainable mechanisation solutions for Indian and global agriculture. "The new centre will substantially strengthen our engineering, testing and validation capabilities while fostering collaborations with leading global technology partners and research institutions," Ravindra added.

Aluminium: Go short on a break below ₹338

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Aluminium prices have been coming down over the last few days. The aluminium futures contract traded on the Multi Commodity Exchange made a high of ₹349 per kg last week and has turned down from there. It is currently trading at ₹340. **COMMODITY CALL.** The fall indicates that the recent rise is just a correction. So, broadly the downward trend that began in June still remains intact. Immediate support is at ₹338. Failure to bounce back from this support will increase the downside pressure. In that case, the contract could fall to ₹328 in a week or two. To avoid this fall, the con-



tract has to sustain above ₹338. If it manages to bounce back from around ₹338, then a rise to ₹350 is possible. We expect the contract to break ₹338 and fall to ₹328.

TRADE STRATEGY Go short on a break below ₹338 with stop-loss at ₹342. Trail the stop-loss down to ₹336 when it dips to ₹333. Revise the stop-loss lower to ₹334 and ₹332 when the price touches ₹332 and ₹330, respectively. Exit the shorts at ₹329.

CMFRI develops digital tools for awareness on protected sharks

Our Bureau
Kochi

To boost awareness and conservation of protected and endangered sharks and rays, the ICAR-Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (ICAR-CMFRI) has launched a mobile app, Shark Aware, and an interactive e-learning module. The digital tools were unveiled by Kerala Fisheries Minister VE Abdul Gafoor. They were developed by a team led by Livi Wilson, Senior Scientist, Finfish Fisheries Division, with financial support from the National Fisheries Development Board (NFDB). The Shark Aware app enables users to identify legally protected sharks and rays while providing easy access to scientific, legal and con-



servation-related information. It covers elasmobranch species listed under Schedules I, II and IV of the Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972, as amended in 2022.

CONSERVATION EFFORTS The app includes species identification features, legal protection status, international trade regulations and conservation significance in a user-friendly format.

According to Wilson, the app will help fishermen, fisheries officials, wildlife enforcement personnel, researchers, students and the public accurately identify protected sharks and rays, support enforcement of the Wild Life (Protection) Act and strengthen conservation efforts. The interactive e-learning module is a self-paced platform designed to improve knowledge of protected sharks and rays. It features multiple-choice quizzes, instant assessments and progress tracking, and covers the Wild Life (Protection) Act, the Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora, species identification and the conservation importance of protected elasmobranchs.

IndiGo added 330 pilots in FY26, says annual report

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

IndiGo added 330 pilots in FY26, according to its latest annual report.

While the airline added 14 destinations and operated 2 per cent more flights compared to fiscal 2025, its headcount rose by 858 to 41,907 employees.

IndiGo ended FY26 with 5,786 pilots and 11,203 cabin crew. During the year, it added 991 cabin crew, its annual report said.

IndiGo's pilot numbers were a topic of regulatory scrutiny following massive disruption of its flights last December. The disruption occurred as the airline failed to adequately plan for the revised pilot duty time norms.

India's civil aviation regulator, the Directorate General of Civil Aviation, had ordered a 10 per cent cut in IndiGo's flights last December and had given it time till February 2026 to implement the new norms.

According to reports, IndiGo is planning to hire 1,000 pilots to keep pace with its expansion plans.

J&J to pay \$5.5 billion to settle talc-related cancer claims

FINAL VERDICT. Proposed resolution represents an efficient conclusion to lawsuits

Bloomberg

Johnson & Johnson on Monday said it agreed to a \$5.5 billion commitment to resolve years of litigation related to claims that its talc products caused ovarian cancer. The drugmaker said the proposed resolution represents "an efficient conclusion" to the lawsuits.

The agreement requires the participation of lead plaintiff firms in ovarian talc litigation pending in state and federal courts that represent at least 95 per cent of claims, according to J&J.

If enough plaintiffs sign on, the settlement will help bring to a close an issue that's dogged J&J for at least 15 years.

The women who sued allege that J&J's hallmark baby powder and similar products made from talc were contaminated with the cancerous substance asbestos. The company denies that the



GLOBAL PHASEOUT. The company denies that the powder is harmful, but it stopped selling talc-based baby powder in the US in 2020 and worldwide in 2023

powder is harmful, but it stopped selling talc-based baby powder in the US in 2020 and worldwide in 2023.

FEDERAL RULES

Critics long complained that the company, one of the most profitable in the world, was trying to use special federal rules only available to bankrupt businesses to shield itself from the lawsuits.

The company has steadfastly maintained talc

doesn't cause cancer and that there's never been any asbestos in its baby powder — a central claim of the lawsuits against the company. J&J faced roughly 76,000 suits, though analysts predicted last year that number could balloon to more than 90,000.

"It provides finality to a saga," Mizuho healthcare specialist Jared Holz said of the settlement.

In June, J&J said it had set aside \$11 billion to settle

legal matters around the issue. It was unlikely a court was going to dismiss the claims, and the company faced a likely cost of \$10 billion to \$12 billion in settlement costs if 93,000 suits were filed, Bloomberg Intelligence analyst Holly Froum wrote last week.

J&J was told by a California jury last October to pay \$966 million to the family of a deceased woman who blamed her cancer on lifelong use of the company's baby powder in the largest verdict for a single user in the litigation.

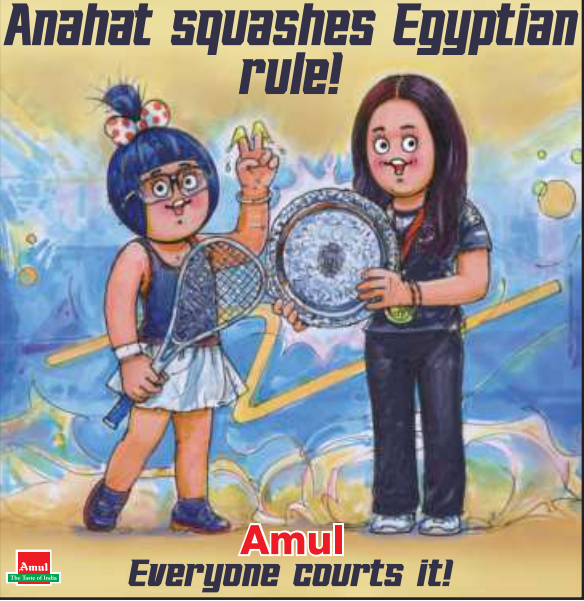
"While we are confident the company would have ultimately prevailed with further litigation, as it has in the vast majority of cases tried to date, this resolution allows the company to put this matter behind it and remain focused on its mission to develop medicines and devices that save lives," J&J Vice President of Litigation Erik Haas said in the statement on the company's website.

US Senators agree on new Russia, Iran sanctions Bill

Bloomberg

A bipartisan group of senators announced a deal on Tuesday on long-awaited legislation to allow President Donald Trump to impose more restrictions on major buyers of Russian energy and Iran. Trump has signalled support for the measure, which had been championed by the late Senator Lindsey Graham, and a procedural vote is set for late Tuesday.

The Bill extends penalties on Iran and singles out Russian gas and oil exports, empowering the President to target the top five buyers of Russian crude and natural with tariffs and the top five countries aiding Russia's energy sanctions evasion, according to text released on Tuesday. While long sought by Graham and other supporters of Ukraine, the legislation could jeopardise the already volatile US trade relationships with China and India, top buyers of Russian energy. Some Democratic lawmakers oppose the Bill, warning it could be used by Trump as a legal justification for new tariffs.



Plant source Vitamin D3 brightens prospects of Fermenta Biotech

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai

Vitamin D3 is required at all stages of life, "from the cradle to the grave", says Fermenta Biotech Managing Director Prashant Nagre, on the prospects that open up for their plant-source Vitamin D3 (Vitadee Green) which recently received approval from the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India's (FSSAI).

The ingredient can now be used in food, as well as health supplements and nutraceutical supplements, he pointed out. Fermenta has a presence in the regular Vitamin D3 segment, but the company explored a sustainable natural source and found it in a byproduct of soybean oil.

Oil from soybean seeds gets refined and goes into food, but the byproduct was available.

RAW MATERIAL

"We get an intermediate from there [the byproduct] ... and that becomes my starting [point]," Nagre explained, on the research to ensure that food crops were not diverted for the purpose.

"So, we have a raw material coming out of [a] plant system... It is sustainable, it is also scalable because soybean is a large crop in India... And the economics when the byproducts are used is also favourable to the farmer in increasing his income," Nagre told *businessline*, adding that keeping it sustainable, scalable and affordable was the objective, when they started research in 2014.



Prashant Nagre, MD, Fermenta Biotech

Edible oil and milk are allowed to be fortified, he said, pointing to possibilities for large-scale adoption.

Fermenta Biotech was a subsidiary of DIL (Duphar-Interfran Ltd) and following a reverse merger (2017-18), Fermenta remains on the BSE and is now looking to list on the NSE as well. Vitamin D sales account for over 70 per cent of Fermenta's total revenue of ₹551 crore for the year ended March 2026.

DIL was listed in 1976 on Bombay Stock Exchange, he says, adding that few companies are listed on BSE for 50 years. "About a month ago we also announced that we want to get listed on NSE and we have made applications to NSE... We are undergoing that process for a full listing on NSE," he added.

The company is looking to ramp up over the next three months to tap possibilities in India and overseas, said Nagre. "Industry has an alternative. We can use now the plant-based, it is D3, it is what the body makes and it is sustainable, scalable as well as affordable... and from a company which has done D3 for [the] last six decades," he added.

House panel rejects govt reply on fixing anti-cancer medicine prices

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

A Parliamentary Standing Committee has urged the Centre to urgently introduce a permanent mechanism to regulate trade margins on life-saving anti-cancer medicines and other drugs, saying prolonged delays in reforming the drug pricing framework have kept essential treatments expensive for patients.

In its Action Taken Report tabled in Parliament on Monday, the Standing Committee on Chemicals and Fertilizers also made it clear that it was not satisfied with most of the government's response to its earlier recommendations.

Of the 11 recommendations made in its original report on medicine prices, the Committee said only four had been accepted by the government, while replies to seven recommendations, including those relating to regulation of non-scheduled medicines, trade margin ra-

tionalisation, excessive mark-ups by drug companies and price regulation of anti-cancer medicines, were not accepted and required reiteration.

The committee said the Department of Pharmaceuticals should accord the "highest priority" to amending the Drugs (Prices Control) Order (DPCO), 2013, to provide a permanent legal basis for Trade Margin Rationalisation (TMR) for life-saving drugs such as anti-cancer medicines.

EXTRAORDINARY POWERS

The panel said relying on extraordinary powers under the existing law for temporary interventions was insufficient to ensure long-term transparency and affordability.

The committee noted that the Department had informed it that extensive consultations had been held with pharmaceutical companies, industry associations and consumer groups on introducing a permanent TMR

framework, but the proposal was still under examination after stakeholders raised concerns over the extent of trade margin caps, exemptions for low-priced medicines, implementation methodology and the impact on MSMEs.

The Centre also pointed out that it had capped trade margins at 30 per cent for 42 selected non-scheduled anti-cancer medicines in 2019, reducing prices of 526 brands by an average of around 50 per cent and resulting in estimated annual savings of ₹984 crore for patients.

UNDER CONSIDERATION

However, the committee said the issue had remained under consideration since the Covid-19 period and criticised the "inordinate delay" in institutionalising the framework.

It said that while the concerns of manufacturers should be addressed, ensuring affordable medicines for patients must remain paramount, and called on the Department to expedite imple-



mentation of a permanent TMR mechanism.

The report also reiterates several broader recommendations on medicine pricing after finding the government's replies unsatisfactory.

EXISTING FRAMEWORK

The committee said the existing framework should be reviewed as nearly 82 per cent of the pharmaceutical market comprises non-scheduled medicines that remain outside direct price control.

It recommended revisiting the current mechanism, under which manufacturers can set the initial price of

non-scheduled medicines while being restricted only from increasing the MRP by more than 10 per cent annually thereafter. It also sought details of medicines where trade margins exceed 100 per cent over the distributor price. The panel further recommended empowering the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) to better regulate excessive pricing of non-scheduled medicines and sought specific responses from the Department on concerns it had raised over regulatory gaps, transparency in Price to Stockist (PTS) data and pricing of non-scheduled fixed-dose combinations.

"TRADE GENERICS"

Another recommendation relates to "trade generics"—medicines largely sold through rural and remote distribution channels. Rejecting the Department's justification that higher logistics and inventory costs explain the large gap between distributor prices and MRPs, the committee re-

commended urgent price regulation of trade generics to protect patients in rural areas.

The committee also asked the Department to disclose details of stakeholder consultations held over the past three years, including recommendations made by industry associations, NGOs, health experts and medical practitioners on pricing of non-scheduled medicines, and explain how those suggestions had been addressed.

Meanwhile, the government defended the current framework under the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Policy (NPPP), 2012, saying it balances affordability with industry growth.

It said analysis of around 98,000 stock keeping units (SKUs) showed that about 87 per cent of the non-scheduled market had weighted average trade margins of up to 45 per cent, while only around 4 per cent had margins exceeding 100 per cent, indicating that very high mark-ups were confined to a small segment of the market.



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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE CI	
Polycab Ind	901.00	912.50	906.00	914.30	900.00	442.15	10126.00	6020.00	-	-	
Polyplex	1161.90	1141.35	1168.00	1168.00	1136.50	34.49	1179.50	743.00	60	1139.15	
Pondawallam	465.10	465.65	465.90	468.10	458.35	47.46	57.00	361.20	-	-	
Pondy Oxydes	522.80	513.00	523.00	527.40	510.00	416.37	1615.00	510.00	-	-	
Power Finance	42.00	41.90	42.00	42.50	41.47	4099.11	448.65	330.05	7	420.25	
Power grid	788.85	265.30	267.30	288.00	263.70	71.8854	34.84	250.05	17	285.30	
Power Infra	140.07	140.00	140.00	140.00	140.00	140.00	140.00	140.00	-	-	
Power Trad	16.36	16.59	16.37	16.77	16.15	366.73	22.90	14.90	12	16.58	
Powertec Ltd	565.70	548.15	569.00	569.00	543.00	110.41	67.95	36.10	-	-	
POWERMCH	29.00	42.30	29.00	69.00	26.00	16.17	28.95	30.00	28	26.42	
Praj Indltd [C]	31.00	30.24	31.55	31.60	30.00	1863.61	485.60	27.05	40	30.25	
Prakash Ind	12.47	12.64	12.50	12.64	12.36	146.46	19.01	11.00	10	12.80	
PRAGEV.	30.01	285.30	299.00	324.00	284.33	127.90	35.00	21.00	40	285.30	
Pranava	29.85	28.33	28.63	29.00	28.30	263.90	19.40	52	138.35	-	
Precision Wr [1]	37.35	36.60	37.35	37.30	36.40	112.20	41.67	16.90	44	36.825	
Premier Enr	103.90	101.50	103.00	104.70	101.50	449.21	114.00	60.00	-	-	
Premi Exp [C]	149.00	125.15	149.00	157.50	160.65	25.57	32.95	37.80	72	62.625	
prestige Est	164.60	168.20	165.80	168.00	163.80	61.858	184.65	109.94	36.9	1683.00	
Pricol Ltd [1]	66.35	66.10	66.35	66.80	66.00	54.00	34.05	69.45	41.25	39	66.35
Prithvi Indus [1]	287.75	288.10	287.75	288.10	287.75	288.10	287.75	288.10	-	288.30	
Primo Chem	29.24	27.22	27.22	27.30	27.00	88.05	15.00	16.10	-	-	
Prince Pipe	26.55	26.50	26.47	26.75	25.90	80.53	35.80	20.50	-	-	
Prism Cement	108.85	106.98	109.10	109.26	106.47	71.13	127.15	10.95	-	107.15	
Prism Infra	22.19	22.15	22.00	22.15	21.85	10.00	22.15	21.85	-	-	
Procter&Gam	8993.50	8973.00	8993.00	8993.00	8915.50	9.68	14536.00	8690.00	34	8965.90	
Prodaminfo	12.41	12.174	12.403	12.403	12.101	63.91	25.49	11.64	-	-	
PROMETHEUS	29.00	28.65	29.00	29.00	28.65	29.00	29.00	28.65	-	-	
Prudent Corp	287.00	200.00	287.00	287.00	285.00	106.13	316.10	212.00	-	-	
PSPPROJECT	105.90	102.00	105.00	105.00	102.10	35.02	141.00	56.30	76	102.30	
PTC Ind	1993.00	1787.00	1984.00	1990.00	1779.00	71.8	1985.00	1355.00	-	-	
PTCL SER	29.24	28.33	28.63	29.00	28.30	263.90	19.40	52	138.35	6	28.82
Pudumjee P [1]	95.75	96.60	96.62	96.88	95.81	21.66	14.05	63.11	10	96.65	
Punjab Natl [1]	111.20	111.65	111.62	112.31	111.10	1568.44	11.35	98.50	6	111.65	
PUNJABNSIND	23.89	23.71	23.89	23.99	23.63	75.21	32.47	10.46	12	23.68	
Punjab State	22.19	22.15	22.00	22.15	21.85	10.00	22.15	21.85	-	-	
PVP Ven	27.40	27.22	27.40	28.23	27.01	460.81	39.88	18.26	-	-	
PVR Info	112.30	111.00	112.22	116.30	110.07	44.22	14.87	90.70	-	-	
Pyramid Tech	19.36	18.36	19.80	19.80	18.15	88.85	19.80	90.70	-	-	

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Quadrant Fut

QUESC

362.70

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358.90

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502.40

248.55

20

303.85

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE CI	
RACIL Search	1332.20	1300.40	1340.10	1340.00	1295.00	12.24	1691.90	805.00	-	-	
Radhakrishna	68.03	68.67	67.90	69.85	66.81	172.71	111.00	100.01	-	-	
Rajesh Ind	159.00	149.80	149.80	150.00	148.00	43.00	149.00	149.00	-	149.80	
Raghuvar	1292.70	1264.40	1287.10	1300.00	1251.00	38.27	1371.80	561.30	-	-	
Rail Tel	288.55	286.55	288.55	299.00	284.65	32.57	41.92	24.50	-	-	
Rajendra Ind	74.74	72.20	72.20	74.28	72.75	95.84	22.75	9.50	74	72.205	
Rainbow Chn	1483.50	1469.50	1489.00	1489.00	1464.00	2.20	1593.70	1084.00	-	-	
Rajputa Seta	134.33	139.35	139.34	140.50	133.83	41.92	14.00	101.70	-	-	
Rajputa Seta	59.70	58.45	59.70	59.70	58.45	59.70	58.45	59.70	-	-	
Rajputa Seta	21.69	20.28	22.25	22.45	19.30	33.58	26.65	14.25	-	-	
Rishi India [1]	22.19	21.561	22.19	22.19	21.485	103.65	36.95	21.610	18	21.610	
Ram Ratna Wr	42.50	43.05	42.40	43.20	40.50	80.275	78.95	26.800	-	-	
Ram Ratna Wr	91.00	91.00	91.00	91.00	91.00	91.00	91.00	91.00	-	91.00	
Ramco Inds [1]	33.865	33.205	33.25	34.190	33.10	147.15	39.05	23.070	71	33.155	
Rane Holid	176.72	174.00	175.80	176.40	173.00	7.88	183.60	98.205	-	-	
Rane Holid	114.00	114.00	114.00	114.00	114.00	114.00	114.00	114.00	-	114.00	
Rashtr. Chem	80.145	78.50	80.375	81.000	77.30	34.531	81.285	27.650	-	-	
Rashtr. Chem	126.27	126.30	126.01	127.19	125.34	65.44	61.64	106.10	18	126.20	
Ratnadipti	32.03	31.58	32.28	32.28	31.50	44.62	64.00	24.40	-	-	
Ratnadipti	90.90	90.21	90.90	91.30	90.21	90.90	91.30	90.21	-	-	
Ratnam M [2]	240.34	235.60	240.00	241.00	235.00	19.78	334.25	190.05	37	235.75	
Ratnaveer Pr	199.61	186.17	202.28	207.19	183.37	27.12	207.90	130.00	-	-	
Ratnaveer Pr	14.42	14.42	14.42	14.42	14.42	14.42	14.42	14.42	-	-	
Raymond	595.5	576.00	593.95	594.95	571.50	40.02	71.90	320.40	1	576.95	
Raymond Life	70.60	70.75	70.88	72.65	70.60	12.86	130.00	69.25	-	-	
Raymond Life	66.50	66.20	66.00	66.85	64.05	27.16	73.94	349.00	-	-	
Raymond Life	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	-	17.00	
RBZ Jeweller	14.61	14.486	14.49	14.740	14.01	97.63	17.93	14.00	64	364.80	
RECLTD	38.15	38.28	38.00	37.10	36.25	42.251	40.345	30.410	6	36.850	
Reddy's Ind	15.15	15.15	15.15	15.15	15.15	15.15	15.15	15.15	-	15.15	
Redtape	127.28	127.22	127.99	127.99	126.25	125.28	16.33	107.53	-	-	
Ref Refrig [2]	331.55	328.10	334.80	334.90	326.30	42.831	45.404	188.00	18	328.65	
Ref Refrig [2]	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	-	17.00	
Rel Ind	73.60	72.71	73.15	73.65	72.75	42.88	96.40	62.00	167	72.70	
Reliance	128.00	126.70	127.50	127.90	126.50	931.218	161.20	125.055	44	126.70	
Reliance	25.45	25.30	25.45	25.60	24.95	29.91	28.85	19.00	-	25.45	
Reliance Ind	28.10	28.10	28.10	28.10	28.10	28.10	28.10	28.10	-	28.10	
REPCO HOME	39.015	38.475	39.145	39.270	38.830	55.74	45.50	33.380	5	38.840	
REPCO HOME	17.54	17.27	17.47	17.68	17.12	89.53	24.225	11.730	-	17.300	
Rethel Ind	68.10	68.10	68.10	68.10	68.10	68.10	68.10	68.10	-	68.10	
Rhetan TMSI	29.05	29.52	29.53	30.21	29.15	21.81	1864.28	33.01	20.22	-	
Rishi Magnet	40.105	39.185	40.310	40.765	39.070	27.199	53.70	32.035	-	-	
Rishi Magnet	14.55	14.41	14.60	15.30	14.37	56.26	26.79	17.50	65.53	58	14.115
Rishabh Ind	15.70	15.70	15.70	15.70	15.70	15.70	15.70	15.70	-	15.70	
Rishabh Ind	62.40	60.25	60.25	63.110	60.00	10.25	60.82	27.30	-	-	
Ritco Lloy	29.00	29.50	29.51	29.95	28.95	64.84	30.65	16.70	-	-	
Ritco Lloy	11.75	11.75	11.75	11.75	11.75	11.75	11.75	11.75	-	11.75	
RK Forgings [2]	62.45	60.65	62.660	64.100	62.25	310.03	37.35	46.015	29	63.905	
RMC Switch	26.65	25.790	26.495	26.64	25.60	31.25	53.00	25.60	-	-	
RMC Switch	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	17.00	-	17.00	
Romex Rings	137.92	137.56	138.40	139.38	136.32	58.765	14.58	99.79	-	-	
Rossari Bio	51.95	50.40	51.90	52.040	50.30	72.32	71.35	37.50	-	-	
Rossari Tech	97.55	91.610	97.855	100.65	89.00	107.90	112.20	53.95	-	-	
Rota Ind	67.00	66.60	67.00	67.00	66.60	67.00	67.00	66.60	-	-	
Rota Mobile	540.60	551.35	540.60	564.65	535.75	94.150	39.00	410.70	-	-	
RPG Heli [2]	29.810	28.880	29.740	29.640	28.500	83.3	30.800	173.25	44	28.810	
RPS Ind	29.00	29.00	29.00	29.00	29.00	29.00	29.00	29.00	-	29.00	
RSh Kabel	25.25	25.750	25.750	27.500	25.50	58.625	27.755	116.50	-	-	
RSystems Int	21.52	25.84	25.00	26.210	25.25	51.85	54.95	21.350	11	25.435	
RSystems Int	42.30	43.10	42.30	44.15	42.30	44.15	42.30	44.15	-	42.30	
RUBIA REE	15.56	15.330	15.70	15.80	15.30	15.80	15.80	15.30	-	15.56	
RUBIA & CO [1]	16.40	16.20	16.20	16.51	16.20	53.91	20.19	10.50	17	16.205	
Rustal Deco [1]	22.64	18.40	17.64	18.90	17.46	54.200	33.80	12.51	18.36	-	
RVLN	17.35	17.31	22.49	22.49	17.35	22.49	17.35	22.49	-	17.35	

S

S&W Solar

S&W Solar

208.27

206.39

209.00

209.75

205.34

61.30

294.85

148.00

20

206.39

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE CI
S&W Solar	208.27	206.39	209.00	209.75	205.34	61.30	294.85	148.00	-	-
Safaridig	159.00	149.80	149.80	150.00	148.00	43.00	149.00	149.00	-	-
Safari Ind	1594.20	1559.60	1606.00	1606.50	1548.70	17.13	2507.10	1363.10	-	-
Sagar Cement [2]	183.15	178.70	176.00	179.00	171.12	175.12	30.00	149.00	-	177.85
Sagility Ind	42.30	43.10	42.30	44.15	42.30	44.15	42.30	44.15	-	42.30
Sagility Ind	12.00	13.00	13.00	13.00	13.00	13.00	13			

S

SAR Solar

208.27

206.39

209.00

209.75

205.34

683.50

294.85

148.00

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